

Advancing Public-Interest AI in Brazil and Latin America

Institutional Pathways, Governance Gaps, and Strategic
Opportunities for Fundação BRAVA

Prepared for **Fundação BRAVA**

Columbia SIPA Capstone Team

Sanjana Aravamudhan
Bojana Starcevic
Jamal Washington

Jonathan Echavarria
Anshima Varma
Mardiantika Watubun

May 2026

Table of Contents

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS	3
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	4
INTRODUCTION	7
CORE STRATEGIC FOCUS AREA	7
GOVERNANCE CRITERIA FOR PUBLIC-INTEREST AI	8
SECTOR PORTFOLIO	9
METHODOLOGY & APPROACH	11
SECONDARY RESEARCH APPROACH	12
PRIMARY RESEARCH APPROACH	12
STUDY LIMITATIONS	15
PUBLIC-INTEREST AI LANDSCAPE ANALYSIS	20
BRAZIL'S AI POLICY AMBITIONS	20
CONSTRAINT ANALYSIS	21
THE ELECTION YEAR CONSTRAINT	29
PRIMARY RESEARCH NEW INSIGHTS	30
INTERVENTION MODALITIES	32
EVALUATION FRAMEWORK & GOOD GOVERNANCE	34
OVERVIEW & APPROACH	34
FRAMEWORK OVERVIEW	35
EVALUATION FRAMEWORK PROCESS	37
SCORING CRITERIA	37
CRITERIA WEIGHTAGE	40
ANALYSIS & SCORING OF PARTNERS – POTENTIAL INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES	42
INSTITUTION AND PROGRAM OVERVIEW:	43
RECOMMENDED INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES	50
KEY FINDINGS & OBSERVATIONS	53
RECOMMENDATIONS FOR BRAVA	57
STRATEGIC POSITIONING	57
RECOMMENDATION LOGIC	58
NEAR-TERM RECOMMENDATIONS	60
LONGER-TERM RECOMMENDATIONS	68
WHAT TO AVOID	70
PROPOSED FIRST MOVE	71
BRAVA ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY	73
GRANT DESIGN	73
PARTNER RELATIONSHIPS	77
MONITORING, EVALUATION, AND LEARNING (MEL) & MEASURING IMPACT	79
CONCLUSION	83
APPENDIX	84
APPENDIX A: BRAVA SECTOR PORTFOLIO	84
APPENDIX B: INSTITUTIONAL READINESS: MULTI-DIMENSIONAL ASSESSMENT	88
APPENDIX C: KEY ACTORS LANDSCAPE	91
APPENDIX D: FULL PARTNER SCORING	93

Acknowledgements

This report was made possible through the contributions of individuals and organizations committed to advancing responsible and equitable AI governance in Brazil's public sector. We express our sincere gratitude to the government officials, civil society leaders, researchers, philanthropic actors, and institutional representatives who generously shared their time, expertise, and perspectives throughout this process.

We gratefully acknowledge the contributions of our interview participants, whose insights were central to shaping the findings and recommendations of this report:

Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC); Guilherme Cintra, Director of Innovation and Technology, Fundação Lemann; Tiago Maluta, Fundação Lemann; Manuella Maia Ribeiro, NIC.br; Fabio Roberto de Miranda, Program Director of the Computer Science Program and Gustavo Macedo, Coordinator of AI research Hub, Insper; Maria Luiza Paranhos and the Columbia Global Center Rio team; Laryssa Nunes and Claudio Mendes, Instituto Decodifica; Ana Ligia Scachetti, Nova Escola; Thomaz Galvão, MegaEdu; Marianna Sampaio, Chief of Staff to State Representative Marina Helou, São Paulo Legislative Assembly; London Swift, Principal of Strategic Partnerships, Omidyar Network; Julia Henriques, Alandar; and a senior official at the National Data Protection Authority (ANPD) who participated on condition of anonymity.

We are also grateful to the broader network of civil society actors, researchers, and practitioners in Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo who engaged with the team during in-country fieldwork in April 2026. Their willingness to speak candidly about the realities of AI governance in Brazil gave this research much of its depth.

Finally, we thank Fundação BRAVA: Letícia Piccolotto Ferriera, Evelyn Hirose, and Mariana Soares – for their trust, engagement, and partnership throughout this study. Their openness in sharing BRAVA's mission, operating model, and strategic priorities made this work possible, and their commitment to evidence-based institutional change in Brazil is what motivated it.

Executive Summary

This report presents findings and strategic recommendations from an analysis of Brazil's public-interest AI landscape, conducted for Fundação BRAVA. The objective is to identify where philanthropic capital can most effectively strengthen the institutional conditions required for responsible, scalable, and durable AI adoption in Brazil's public sector.

AI is already being deployed across public services in Brazil – including social protection, education, and administrative systems – reflecting strong political and institutional appetite for adoption. However, these deployments are unfolding within governance environments that remain uneven and, in many cases, underdeveloped. As a result, the central challenge shifts from whether AI will be adopted, to whether public institutions have the capacity, coordination, and oversight mechanisms to shape that adoption in ways that generate lasting public value.

The key findings of this report include:

- **Governance fragmentation:** Responsibility for AI governance is distributed across federal actors without an effective coordination mechanism, while state and municipal governments operate with limited oversight or guidance. As a result, national strategies do not consistently translate into subnational implementation.
- **Vendor-driven decision-making:** In the absence of technical and governance capacity within government, private vendors often shape system design and procurement decisions. This dynamic is most acute at the subnational level, where institutions face significant asymmetries in expertise.
- **Institutional capacity gaps:** Public sector actors—particularly at the state and municipal levels—lack the technical, procurement, and governance capabilities required to evaluate, implement, and oversee AI systems effectively.
- **Limited civil society access to governance processes:** Organizations engaged in AI accountability and oversight are often excluded from key decision-making spaces, not due to lack of expertise, but due to structural barriers to participation and sustained engagement.

- **Political timing constraints:** The 2026 electoral cycle limits the feasibility of near-term, government-dependent reforms, reinforcing the need for investments that generate durable institutional capacity independent of political turnover.

These findings suggest that Brazil's AI trajectory remains open: the country has not yet locked in the institutional or technological dependencies that have constrained governance outcomes elsewhere in Latin America. This creates a window of opportunity to shape how AI is embedded in the public sector before current gaps become entrenched.

Based on this analysis, five strategic directions emerge for philanthropic engagement:

	Recommendation	Rationale	Partner	Ideal Outcomes	Ideal Indicators
1 <i>Fund applied policy research on AI governance failures in Brazil's public sector</i> Modality 1 & Modality 3	Fund a sustained applied research program that provides policymakers with actionable insights on AI governance failures in Brazil's public sector, focusing on procurement decisions, accountability structure and data systems	Despite Brazil's significant AI deployment across sectors, there is no credible independent body which exists to capture transferable learning from failures. This recommendation seeks to bridge this gap, by ensuring funding for a program that generates a diagnostic foundation for AI investments.	InternetLab: Data Justice and Social Protection Policies program	- Two research outputs published - Co-funding from at least one additional source sustained program - Research agenda is actively informing executive education curriculum	- Curriculum updates for further recommendations driven by research findings - Research outputs cited in regulatory consultations or by other ecosystem actors
2 <i>Fund executive education for state and municipal public managers on AI governance</i> Modality 1	Invest in an intensive 1-2 week executive education program, focused on building AI governance literacy among state and municipal public managers, equipping them with practical AI governance skills	Executive education on a state and municipal level addresses governance culture challenges and builds durable human capital across administrations. Additionally UCL's "Teaching Public Service in the Digital Age" program is already adapted for Brazil, offering a plug-and play starting point	Inspier: Existing relationship and proven track record with consistent funding from other funders	- Complete pilot of 30-50 public managers - Learnings applied to procurement in ~ 3 municipalities/ states - Curriculum updated using findings from Rec.1	- Completion of program with an AI procurement evaluation framework - Curriculum updates driven by Rec.1 research findings - Utilization of program frameworks
3 <i>Provide multi-year institutional funding for civil society AI oversight and accountability</i> Modality 3	Provide multi-year funding to suitable civil society organizations working on AI governance and accountability, with explicit support for participation in regulatory forums where AI decisions are being shaped.	Closes the loop on Rec.1 and 2, addressing the gap where without civil society accountability pressure, research goes unread and learnings from trainings remain unapplied. Multi-year institutional grants are the instrument that ensures oversight is durable.	Base dos Dados: Maintains a track record of making complex data accessible, and has an active partnership with Lemann Foundation	- Presence of funded entities in APND consultations ~ 1 formal policy submission produced and in circulation - Core program continuity and staff retention until year 2	- Research outputs cited in regulatory consultations or by other ecosystem actors - Presence of funded entities in relevant policy forums - Organizational stability
4 <i>Support responsible AI adoption in public education with a youth well-being lens</i> Modality 1 & Modality 3	Invest in an entity that supports the safe and equitable adoption of AI in education, modeling responsible deployment for teachers and students while generating governance evidence to inform Brazil's regulatory approach.	Brazil's significant educational gap, combined with low English proficiency and dominance of general-purpose AI models, presents an opportunity for targeted AI integration in public education to improve long-term social well-being of youth.	Nova Escola: Informed and reliable partner for BRAVA to support youth and social well-being in scholastic AI adoption	~1 AI tool deployed in public schools with oversight ~ 1 research output on youth AI governance - Governance findings shared with Rec.1 as a case study	- Curriculum updates driven by Rec.1 research findings - Research outputs cited in regulatory consultations or by other ecosystem actors

 Highest-confidence recommendation

These recommendations are designed to function not as isolated interventions, but as a coordinated portfolio that addresses the systemic conditions shaping AI adoption. Each intervention targets a distinct constraint while reinforcing broader institutional capacity, governance quality, and long-term public sector performance.

BRAVA is well-positioned to play a key role in shaping the institutional environment in which AI adoption occurs, ensuring AI systems strengthen rather than undermine the effectiveness, accountability, and legitimacy of Brazil's public sector.

Introduction

1



BRAVA's existing scope of work, partnership criteria, and theories of change collectively define the parameters of this study and the context for assessing potential investment opportunities in public-interest AI.

The BRAVA Foundation (Fundação BRAVA), founded in 2000 and based in São Paulo, facilitates the development of innovative public management approaches in Brazil. Operating as a strategic grant-maker with a small, agile team, BRAVA functions faster and more dynamically than traditional NGOs — incubating programs, providing technical assistance, and convening partners across education, health, housing, and governance. Its primary role is to strengthen the institutional conditions in which innovation occurs, rather than to deploy or implement solutions directly.

WHY BRAVA IS UNIQUELY POSITIONED

BRAVA's operating model positions the organization as a governance-oriented ecosystem builder. Rather than developing or deploying technology directly, BRAVA strengthens the institutional conditions in which innovation occurs. This positioning is especially relevant in the context of AI, where long-term public value depends less on technical capabilities and more on the strength of the institutions responsible for governing deployment. BRAVA's current initiatives — in talent pipelines, public-sector capacity building, and evidence-based policy infrastructure — demonstrate a track record of investing in exactly these conditions.

Core Strategic Focus Area

BRAVA's core strategic focus areas coalesce around its mission of building a more equitable, efficient, and resilient society. Each is advanced through support for high-impact initiatives, dissemination of evidence-based best practices, and enhancement of public sector management capabilities.

Public Sector Strengthening	Education, Skilling & Workforce Development	Civil Society & Philanthropy
Invests in structural vectors of change that modernize, professionalize, and strengthen Brazilian public institutions over time. Emphasis on apolitical, non-partisan institutional engagement. e.g. Renova BR	Strengthens talent pipelines through scholarships, entrepreneurship support, and leadership development programs aligned with Brazil's long-term innovation needs. e.g. Fundação Estudar, Endeavor, IMPA Tech	Builds institutional capacity for public managers and civil society organizations, reinforcing the human capital foundation of Brazil's public sector. e.g. Insper CGPP, GovTech Fellows

Governance Criteria for Public-Interest AI

Public-interest AI literature argues that automated AI systems generate durable public value only when embedded within institutional frameworks that promote accountability, legitimacy, and equitable access. For BRAVA, this framing repositions AI investment from an innovation question into a governance challenge — one that warrants careful attention to institutional readiness.

The SIPA team identified five governance pillars representing the minimum conditions required for AI systems to advance the public good in Brazil, with one additional pillar identified in close collaboration with BRAVA:

EQUITY & INCLUSIVE ACCESS	TRANSPARENCY	ACCOUNTABILITY & DEMOCRATIC OVERSIGHT
INSTITUTIONAL CAPACITY & READINESS	PUBLIC VALUE	YOUTH & SOCIAL WELL-BEING

These pillars function as practical investment filters rather than abstract ethical aspirations. An AI system that demonstrates strong technical performance but lacks transparency, auditability, or redress mechanisms would fail this framework regardless of its efficiency gains. They provide a tool for distinguishing between systems that generate short-term technological outputs and those capable of delivering sustained institutional value.

ALIGNMENT WITH BRAVA'S MISSION

Two pillars have particularly strong resonance with BRAVA's existing work: **Institutional Capacity & Readiness** and **Equity & Inclusive Access**. These governance pillars do not introduce a new logic for BRAVA — they speak directly to criteria already embedded in BRAVA's approach to institutional change. BRAVA's preference for credible partners and measurable outcomes reinforces accountability; its political neutrality underscores democratic legitimacy; its focus on scalable impact speaks directly to publicly justified AI deployment.

Sector Portfolio

BRAVA maintains a sector-agnostic approach, ensuring portfolio diversity while prioritizing high-impact initiatives. Historically, BRAVA's work has spanned public health, governance, education, social inclusion, and agriculture — always with a preference for political neutrality in partner selection. This breadth is relevant context for the AI governance entry point: BRAVA is not entering an unfamiliar space but extending an established institutional logic into a domain where the evidence base is critically underdeveloped.

Full program descriptions and outcomes for each initiative are set out in [Appendix A](#).

Methodology & Approach

2



A three-phase framework designed to ground BRAVA's strategic entry in rigorous, layered evidence.

This study was structured around a three-phase MAP → ASSESS → RECOMMEND framework designed to reflect BRAVA's operating model. Rather than evaluating individual AI deployments in isolation, the research assessed the broader ecosystem conditions – governance, capacity, and accountability – that determine whether AI can generate durable public value in the Brazilian context. The framework was chosen deliberately: BRAVA does not deploy technology or implement programs directly, and the most relevant questions for its investment decisions are about the institutional environment in which Brazil’s AI systems operate.

PHASE 1 Map	PHASE 2 Assess	PHASE 3 Recommend
Comprehensive review of Brazil's regulatory and legislative environment — PL 2338/2023, LGPD, EBIA, and sector frameworks. Full actor landscape mapped across government, civil society, research, private sector, and global philanthropy. Institutional readiness assessed using three complementary analytical frameworks.	Eight public-sector AI use cases examined across four partnership modalities. Cases evaluated against BRAVA's six governance pillars. Global benchmarks from Estonia, Finland, and Argentina assessed for transferable lessons. Primary IDIs stress-tested secondary findings and surfaced BRAVA's partnership criteria and risk posture.	Landscape and assessment findings translated into targeted investment recommendations. Specific partner organizations, program types, and engagement approaches identified against BRAVA's partnership criteria, theory of change, and risk posture. Recommendations structured across near-term and longer-term horizons.

Secondary Research Approach

This study's primary research was preceded and informed by a comprehensive secondary research phase that established the analytical foundation for the landscape analysis, use case mapping, and global benchmarking. The desk research drew on four categories of sources: international governance frameworks and index reports, including the Oxford Insights Government AI Readiness Index, the OECD Principles on Artificial Intelligence, and UNESCO's Brazil-specific Readiness Assessment Report; legislative and regulatory documents, including PL 2338/2023, the LGPD, the Marco Civil da Internet, and the EBIA national strategy; academic and applied research on specific Brazilian AI systems and public-interest AI theory; and internal BRAVA materials alongside philanthropic ecosystem resources that situated BRAVA's operating model within the wider global landscape for public-interest AI funding.

Secondary research shaped the in-depth interview design across three functions: validating preliminary diagnostic claims about Brazil's AI landscape against practitioner experience; filling gaps where available literature was insufficiently specific to BRAVA's operational context; and mapping the key actors landscape to identify which institutions BRAVA should engage selectively and which carried political exposure that would conflict with its neutrality requirements. Across all three functions, the desk research structured the inquiry so that interviews could move efficiently from established context into the organization-specific insights that secondary sources alone cannot provide. Full source documentation and the secondary research framework analysis are set out in Appendix A.

Primary Research Approach

14 Stakeholder Interviews	6 Stakeholder Categories	6 In-person Interviews conducted	2 Cities visited for fieldwork
--	---------------------------------------	---	---

Stakeholders were identified through the landscape analysis and selected to triangulate perspectives across four categories: BRAVA internal leadership (mission, theory of change, partnership criteria); government actors (regulatory capacity and coordination mechanisms); civil society and research institutions (oversight infrastructure and technical credibility); and global philanthropic actors (transferable lessons in public-interest AI funding).

In-Depth Interview Stakeholders

Sector	Institution	Country	Purpose	Format
Public Sector	ANPD	Brazil	Validation	Virtual
	MEC	Brazil	Validation	Virtual
	Sao Paulo Legislative Assembly	Brazil	Validation	In-person
Multilateral	UNESCO in Brazil	Brazil	Validation	Virtual
Academic	Insper	Brazil	Engagement	In-Person
	Lemann Foundation	Brazil	Engagement	Virtual
Civil Society	Instituto Decodifica	Brazil	Engagement	In-Person
	Alandar	Brazil	Validation	In-person
	Cetic.br & NIC.br	Brazil	Validation	Virtual
	Mega Edu	Brazil	Engagement	Virtual
	InternetLab	Brazil	Validation	Virtual
	FGV Direito Rio	Brazil	Validation	Virtual
Private Sector	InvestSP	Brazil	Engagement	In-person
Global Funder	Omidyar Network	United States	Benchmarking	Virtual

QUESTIONNAIRE DEVELOPMENT

Interview questionnaires were structured around BRAVA's six governance pillars: Equity and Inclusive Access, Institutional Capacity and Readiness, Accountability and Democratic Oversight, Youth and Societal Well-Being, Transparency, and Public Value – and tailored by stakeholder category to ensure that questions surfaced implementation realities specific to each actor's position in the ecosystem. Government interviewees were asked to speak to coordination mechanisms and regulatory capacity; civil society actors to oversight infrastructure and funding constraints; academic and research institutions to technical credibility and knowledge production;

and global philanthropic actors to transferable lessons from comparable funding contexts. This design allowed the team to triangulate perspectives across the ecosystem rather than aggregate responses to a uniform instrument.

CONFIDENTIALITY

All interviewees were offered the option of anonymity before each session, and that offer was made unconditional. Where interviewees requested anonymity, no identifying information appears in either the report or the appendix; their contributions are used for synthesis only. Recording was conducted exclusively with explicit prior permission, and interviewees who declined were not recorded. One interviewee, a senior official at ANPD, requested full non-attribution; their account is reflected in the analysis but no direct quotes are attributed to them.

IN-COUNTRY FIELDWORK

The SIPA team conducted in-country fieldwork in Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo from April 13–20, 2026, visiting Columbia Global Center Rio and Insper alongside a set of in-person stakeholder interviews. The fieldwork added meaningful texture to the research that virtual interviews had not produced. In-person conversations consistently generated more candid testimony – interviewees were more willing generally to characterize institutional dynamics, name specific failure modes, and recommend additional stakeholders when speaking face to face. Several of the most consequential findings in this report, including direct accounts of procurement dynamics at the federal level and the subnational capacity differential, emerged from in-person conversations that built sufficient trust to go beyond prepared lines of questioning. The relational character of professional engagement in Brazil, less formal and more warmth-oriented than many international contexts, also reinforced a finding relevant to BRAVA's positioning: its identity as a domestic Brazilian institution is a practical enabler of the kind of access this research required.

Study Limitations

This study was conducted within a defined scope, timeline, and set of access conditions that introduce several limitations relevant to the confidence and generalizability of its findings. These are set out transparently below, not as caveats that undermine the analysis, but as honest markers of where the research is most and least robust, and where further inquiry may be warranted in subsequent phases of BRAVA's engagement.

LIMITATION 1 Incomplete public-sector interview coverage

THE GAP:

Interview access skewed heavily toward São Paulo and Rio de Janeiro-based interviewees — a logistical constraint rather than a deliberate design choice. Direct perspectives from key federal regulatory actors in Brasília, including MCTI and other agencies centrally shaping Brazil's AI legislative architecture, are largely absent from the primary data.

WHAT IT AFFECTS:

Findings on the regulatory implementation capacity of federal bodies, internal coordination dynamics between agencies, and federal-level institutional readiness rely more heavily on secondary sources than on direct institutional testimony. Where conclusions are drawn about federal governance gaps, these should be understood as informed by documentary evidence and stakeholder inference rather than first-hand accounts.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Investment decisions touching federal regulatory institutions may warrant direct engagement with Brasília-based actors before partner selection is finalized.

LIMITATION 2 Election year constraint

THE GAP:

Brazil's active pre-election period shaped the research in ways that are difficult to fully disaggregate. Several interviewees with public-sector proximity were notably cautious in their characterizations of government AI initiatives, institutional performance, and the political dimensions of regulatory development — particularly where assessments might carry political implications in the current climate.

WHAT IT AFFECTS:

The primary data likely understates the degree of political friction, inter-institutional tension, and implementation dysfunction relative to what may exist in practice. The election year context also bears on forward-looking elements: a government change following the 2026 elections could meaningfully alter the priorities, personnel, and receptiveness of public institutions BRAVA may seek to engage.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Near-term investments must be designed to hold value through a potential government transition. Any investment contingent on specific institutional relationships or current political configurations carries higher risk than the primary data alone suggests.

LIMITATION 3 Heavy reliance on secondary data

THE GAP:

Across all sectors examined, the research drew substantially on secondary sources including government publications, academic literature, civil society reports, and international frameworks. Secondary materials fail to fully capture and reflect the full on-the-ground implementation realities.

WHAT IT AFFECTS:

The study identifies accountability deficits, data governance fragmentation, and oversight weaknesses across multiple sectors, findings well-supported by documentary evidence, but the depth of understanding of how these gaps manifest in practice would benefit from greater primary data coverage.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Recommendation 1's applied research program is designed in part to close this gap, generating the practitioner-level evidence base the secondary literature cannot provide.

LIMITATION 4**Geographic Concentration of Interviewees****THE GAP:**

The concentration of interviews in São Paulo and Rio de Janeiro introduced not only a geographic skew but a skew in the types of organizations represented. Interviewees were drawn predominantly from civil society organizations, research institutions, and think tanks in these two cities.

WHAT IT AFFECTS:

The study's qualitative findings are more reflective of established, urban civil society than of public managers, subnational government actors, or community organizations operating outside these centers. The analysis may overrepresent the perspectives of organizations already engaged with AI governance discourse and underrepresent the experiences of institutions at the state and municipal level where deployment is occurring with the least oversight.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Investment decisions targeting systemic or subnational impact may require supplementary engagement with actors outside of São Paulo–Rio, particularly state secretariats and municipal-level practitioners.

LIMITATION 5**Limited coverage of global philanthropic actors****THE GAP:**

Engagement with global philanthropic actors remained largely secondary-source based due to lack of availability. The analysis of the global philanthropic landscape draws on publicly available materials from MacArthur, Ford, Omidyar, and related actors.

WHAT IT AFFECTS:

This limits the study's ability to fully characterize the competitive and collaborative landscape within which BRAVA would operate as a funder. Understanding how established global philanthropic actors are positioning themselves in Brazil remains an important area for BRAVA to explore directly.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Direct conversations are needed before BRAVA commits to any specific co-investment structures.

WHERE THE STUDY IS MOST ROBUST

These limitations bear most heavily on findings about federal regulatory capacity and forward-looking elements of the recommendations. The constraint analysis and partner assessments, both grounded in direct IDI evidence from practitioners embedded in the ecosystem, are the most analytically robust elements of the study. The five constraints identified in Section 2 were confirmed independently across multiple stakeholder categories; no single interviewee produced them.

Public-Interest AI Landscape Analysis



Brazil has developed one of the most substantive AI policy agendas in Latin America, but legislative ambition has not yet translated into operational readiness.

Brazil's AI Policy Ambitions

Brazil has developed one of the most substantive AI policy agendas in Latin America. The National AI Strategy (EBIA, 2021) and the Brazilian AI Plan 2024-2028, which commits BRL 23 billion over four years, reflect real political investment in AI as a key feature in the future of Brazil's public sector.¹ The AI Bill (PL 2338/2023), which passed the Senate in December 2024 and is now under Chamber of Deputies review, adopts a risk-based approach modeled on the EU AI Act, with binding requirements for high-risk applications in education, social services, healthcare, recruitment, and biometrics.² Additionally, complementary frameworks include the Marco Civil da Internet (2014), which established foundational internet governance principles including net neutrality and judicial oversight requirements, and the LGPD (2020), Brazil's comprehensive data protection law enforced by ANPD that applies to AI systems processing personal data.³ Together, these frameworks provide the foundational legal infrastructure on which AI governance is being constructed.

These developments represent meaningful progress at the legislative level. However, legislative ambition has not yet translated into operational readiness. The AI Bill's passage through the Senate involved significant revision to core provisions, driven in large part by industry lobbying from U.S. technology firms whose employees met with Brazilian lawmakers "at least 83 times" during the Senate process.⁴ Brazil's multi-party coalition system requires extensive negotiation to advance complex technical legislation and with 2026 general elections approaching, regulatory

¹ Estratégia Brasileira de Inteligência Artificial (EBIA), Brazil | Regulations.AI, 2021; OECD.AI Policy Observatory, "Brazilian AI Strategy 2027," accessed February 2026, <https://oecd.ai/en/dashboards/policy-initiatives/brazilian-ai-strategy-2027>

² Bill No. 2,338/2023 — Brazilian Artificial Intelligence Act. Approved by the Federal Senate, December 10, 2024. Under review by the Chamber of Deputies (Special Committee established April 2025).

³ LGPD — Lei Geral de Proteção de Dados (Law No. 13,709/2018). Brazilian General Data Protection Law.

⁴ Aos Fatos, "Big Tech Lobbying Shaped Brazilian Positions on AI Rules," February 2026, <https://www.aosfatos.org/noticias/big-tech-lobbying-shaped-brazilian-positions-ai-rules/>

movement in the near term is unlikely. The implications of this for BRAVA's investment horizon are addressed directly in the election year analysis below.

***For a full analysis** of Brazil's legislative architecture, regulatory actors, and institutional readiness across Oxford, OECD, and UNESCO frameworks, see [Appendix B](#). For the Key Actors Landscape, see [Appendix C](#).*

Constraint Analysis

Brazil's binding constraint in public-interest AI is more governance and institutional than solely technological. Technical gaps are present and significant, but they are symptoms of a more fundamental problem: the structural gap between regulatory ambition and institutional execution. Primary research confirmed and sharpened five constraints that govern these gaps. Each is presented below with its mechanism and direct implication for BRAVA. These constraints are not independent; they reinforce one another.

Constraint	What it looks like	Why it persists	BRAVA Implication
Fragmented governance	Parallel systems, no shared standards across levels	Leadership frames AI as technology, not governance	Investments may target state and municipal directly, as federal level investment and impact likely won't reach sub nationally
No coordination mechanisms	Ad hoc collaboration, no compounding effect	Institutions incentivized toward ownership, not coordination	Investments may build coordination between actors into design, rather than an afterthought. This is a critical investment characteristic
Data silos	Non-interoperable public systems	No institution will give up control of its data without an external reason to do so	Investments may lean into partner-led initiatives that are building open, reusable data infrastructure systems
Capacity gaps	The decision makers responsible for evaluating and procuring AI systems lack the technical and institutional capacity to define what they actually need	When no one inside an institution knows enough to push back, vendors solely decide what gets built	Investments may train decision-makers to ensure procurement makes sense and serves a benefit
External tech dependence	Reliance on foreign tech and English-language models	No domestic alternative provides a governance reference point	Investments may prioritize partners that aim to build for the Brazilian context

CONSTRAINT 1 Fragmented governance across institutions and levels of government

THE CONSTRAINT:

AI governance responsibilities in Brazil are distributed across at least six major federal actors – Congress, ANPD, TCU, MGI, sectoral regulators, and the proposed CRIA – with no functioning coordination body.⁵ State and municipal AI deployments operate with even less oversight, often without any regulatory framework at all. The picture is uneven even within the federal government: Brazil's Ministério da Educação (MEC) has produced a sophisticated governance framework in their newly released Referencial while simultaneously acknowledging that it lacks the capacity to enforce it at the school level, where implementation authority rests with state and municipal secretariats.⁶

THE EVIDENCE:

Marianna Sampaio (Sao Paulo's Legislative Assembly) described the governance dynamic in direct terms: each department pursues its own flagship digital initiative, producing parallel systems with no interoperability and no shared standards.⁷ Manuel Bonduki (MEC) confirmed the same pattern from within a federal ministry, noting that MEC cannot prohibit schools from adopting particular AI solutions, as that authority belongs to state and municipal secretariats.⁸ An anonymous interviewee from ANPD described Brazil's AI governance as a system involving multiple ministries seeking jurisdiction, producing what they characterized as “coordination in form, but limited coordination in practice.”⁹

“Fragmentation is not just structural – it is reinforced by leadership framing that treats AI as a technical issue rather than a governance problem. When senior leadership defines AI as a technology question, no coordination body gets built because no one with power sees its absence as their problem to solve.” – *Marianna Sampaio*

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

BRAVA's highest-leverage entry point is at the state and municipal level, where both technical capacity and governance literacy gaps are most acute. Federal-level investments rarely produce subnational impact on their own, and optimal coordination across levels of government is unlikely to emerge in the near term. Investments may be designed to function without federal coordination as a precondition.

⁵ Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), *The Path to Becoming a Data-Driven Public Sector in Brazil* (Paris: OECD Publishing, 2020); ANPD, *Priority Themes Map for Supervision (Mapa de Temas Prioritários) 2026–2027*, Resolution CD/ANPD No. 30, December 23, 2025.

⁶ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

⁷ Marianna Sampaio, São Paulo Legislative Assembly, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 19, 2026.

⁸ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

⁹ Interview with senior official, National Data Protection Authority (ANPD), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 3, 2026. [Unattributed at interviewee's request; findings used for synthesis only.]

CONSTRAINT 2 Lack of formal coordination mechanisms

THE CONSTRAINT:

Despite broad multi-stakeholder participation in AI policy debates, these interactions are not institutionalized. Coordination occurs on an ad hoc basis, with no formal body responsible for ensuring consistency in AI standards, governance protocols, or implementation practices across agencies or levels of government.¹⁰ One of the federal government's most concrete responses to this problem – MEC's EducaDados platform, designed to enable student data to follow learners across municipal and state systems – represents genuine progress on a specific interoperability challenge. It also illustrates how narrow and fragmented these solutions remain, as EducaDados addresses just one data gap in one sector, and no equivalent cross-sector mechanism exists.¹¹

THE EVIDENCE:

ANPD interviewee was direct on the structural consequence of this: intergovernmental coordination represents the most critical bottleneck in Brazil's AI governance ecosystem, and without it, resources will continue to be deployed without compounding effect.¹² Bonduki reinforced this from within MEC, noting that the diversity of capacity levels across municipalities, states, and the federal government means solutions cannot be assumed to work uniformly. He added that interoperable, open-source data infrastructure is the necessary bridging layer.¹³ Guilherme Cintra, Director of Innovation and Technology at Fundação Lemann, offered a consistent diagnosis: without a foundational base layer of interoperable data governance, individual AI investments risk producing isolated outputs rather than cumulative system change.¹⁴

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

BRAVA should avoid investments that create additional siloed initiatives. Because institutions have stronger incentives to claim ownership of flagship initiatives than to subordinate them to shared standards, coordination must be embedded as a design condition of the investment itself. BRAVA can own the convening role here without owning infrastructure: organizing cross-governmental knowledge exchange via field trips, seminars, and peer learning is a concrete, lower-cost coordination function that Bonduki identified as a specific philanthropic opportunity.¹⁵

¹⁰ OECD, The Path to Becoming a Data-Driven Public Sector in Brazil, 2020.

¹¹ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

¹² Interview with senior official, National Data Protection Authority (ANPD), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 3, 2026.

¹³ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

¹⁴ Guilherme Cintra, Director of Technology and Innovation, Lemann Foundation, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 17, 2026.

¹⁵ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

CONSTRAINT 3 Data silos and weak interoperability

THE CONSTRAINT:

Brazil's public-sector data systems remain siloed across federal, state, and municipal levels, with no standardized data governance protocols applying consistently across institutions.¹⁶ The consequence is that AI systems are trained and deployed on fragmented, poorly governed data, which undermines both reliability and scalability.

THE EVIDENCE:

Cintra (Fundação Lemann) offered the clearest articulation of the structural problem and what a solution architecture must look like: before meaningful AI adoption is possible, institutions need basic infrastructure (connectivity, devices, and energy), interoperable data governance, and an implementation layer capable of supporting responsible procurement. In practice, funders and governments alike tend to skip directly to the software and AI layer, and the initiatives fail because the layers beneath them were never built.¹⁷ Fabio Roberto de Miranda (Insper) identified Brazil's large reserves of unstructured public data – particularly within the Ministry of Health – as an underutilized asset that cannot be mobilized without governance frameworks to organize and standardize it first.¹⁸

Gatopardos (Lemann portfolio): technically sound literacy software with demonstrated results, but no sustainability plan, no committed coalition. Dead after initial funding. The pilot trap is structural, not incidental.¹⁹

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

BRAVA may consider prioritizing partner-led initiatives that treat data infrastructure as a shared requirement design rather than a problem to be solved later. Because no single institution will give up control of its data without an external reason to do so, interoperability rarely happens on its own; it has to be designed in from the start. A useful question to bring to any investment here is: Who owns and maintains this work once BRAVA's funding ends? Investments that bypass the infrastructure question risk the pilot trap that many interviewees in this space named independently.

¹⁶ OECD, The Path to Becoming a Data-Driven Public Sector in Brazil, 2020.

¹⁷ Guilherme Cintra, Director of Technology and Innovation, Lemann Foundation, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 17, 2026.

¹⁸ Fabio Roberto de Miranda, Insper, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 18, 2026.

¹⁹ Guilherme Cintra, Director of Technology and Innovation, Lemann Foundation, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 17, 2026.

CONSTRAINT 4 Gaps in institutional and technical capacity

THE CONSTRAINT:

The capacity gap in Brazil's AI ecosystem is primarily governance-oriented. Public managers at the state and municipal level frequently lack the foundations needed to evaluate AI vendor claims, assess procurement decisions, or define the problem they are trying to solve before deploying a solution. The practical consequence, as Bonduki described it, is that procurement decisions default to whoever presents the most compelling offer first: in the absence of internal capacity and mentorship, vendors effectively shape what gets built, because decision-makers lack the frameworks to assess what a strategically sound choice would look like.²⁰ That is the current operating reality in significant parts of Brazil's public sector.

THE EVIDENCE:

Bonduki identified the mechanism clearly: the absence of a well-distributed strategic view of AI governance – shared among the key decision-makers in institutions like MEC – leads directly to vendor lock-in and data mismanagement. He pointed to high-level expert forums capable of building consensus among the thirty to forty most consequential decision-makers within major institutions as a specific, high-leverage intervention.²¹ Sampaio reinforced the cultural dimension of this very same problem: the governance gap reflects a leadership and organizational culture challenge as much as a training deficit.²² The ANPD interviewee confirmed that this constraint applies internally as well, noting that AI governance expertise within the regulator itself is concentrated in a small core group, and growing institutional headcount does not resolve the expertise development problem on its own.²³

Both Sampaio and Bonduki identified a specific investment that bridges the capacity and coordination constraints simultaneously: supporting public servants – particularly at subnational levels – to engage with AI not as end users, but as informed managers capable of exercising independent judgement. In a public sector where displacement pressures differ

²⁰ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

²¹ Ibid.

²² Marianna Sampaio, São Paulo Legislative Assembly, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 19, 2026.

²³ Interview with senior official, National Data Protection Authority (ANPD), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 3, 2026.

	structurally from the private sector, well-designed AI literacy investments could represent a significant productivity gain if they reorient how managers approach their roles rather than simply layering new tools onto existing workflows. ²⁴
--	---

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

BRAVA may consider investing in training programs that build the capacity of state and municipal decision-makers to evaluate AI systems and make procurement decisions that actually serve a purpose. The capacity gap and the vendor capture problem work in tandem. When people inside institutions don't know enough to push back, vendors fill that space.

CONSTRAINT 5 Dependence on external foreign technology providers

THE CONSTRAINT:

Brazil's public sector AI ecosystem is substantially reliant on infrastructure and models provided by international technology companies whose systems carry design assumptions that do not always reflect Brazilian institutional realities. Cases such as Google Cloud's Gemini for Government²⁵ and Microsoft-powered platforms in education²⁶ illustrate that Brazil's public agencies are adopting advanced AI tools at a pace that exceeds the development of internal governance mechanisms.

THE EVIDENCE:

Bonduki described what this looks like inside the Ministry of Education (MEC): the absence of internal capacity to evaluate AI systems means that vendor-provided frameworks frequently become the de facto governance standard.²⁷ This is not by design, but because no domestic alternative exists to provide a reference point. Fabio Roberto de Miranda pointed to the growing Soberania movement as evidence that technological dependency is recognized as a structural risk within the domestic ecosystem.²⁸ ANPD interviewee: without sufficient domestic technical capacity, meaningful oversight of

²⁴ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

²⁵ Google Cloud, Google Cloud Brings a New Era of AI Innovation to Brazil, 2025, <https://www.googlecloudpresscorner.com/2025-09-10-Google-Cloud-Brings-a-New-Era-of-AI-Innovation-to-Brazil>

²⁶ Microsoft Brasil, ConectaAI: Programa da Microsoft tem meta de capacitar 5 milhões de brasileiros em IA, 2024, <https://news.microsoft.com/pt-br/conectai-programa-da-microsoft-tem-meta-de-capacitar-5-milhoes-de-brasileiros-em-ia/>

²⁷ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

²⁸ Fabio Roberto de Miranda, Insper, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 18, 2026.

foreign-built systems is limited by the regulator's own ability to understand how those systems function.²⁹ Thiago Camargo (InvestSP) framed it as both an economic and an educational challenge, claiming that "Brazil's reliance on English-language models introduces a structural language barrier for the majority of its population."³⁰

Chile is Latin America's AI readiness leader, with more than 100 automated decision-making processes in operation and binding AI regulation already passed.³¹ Yet it is described by its own government officials, developers, and end-users as a "sandbox nation": a territory where externally developed technologies are tested and deployed on the population rather than shaped by it.³² This is what happens when governance infrastructure arrives after structural technology choices are locked in. Brazil has not yet reached that point. The window to interrupt the trajectory has not yet closed.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Prioritize domestic partners and platforms designed for Brazilian institutional contexts. Because meaningful oversight of foreign-built systems is impossible without domestic technical capacity to evaluate them, the dependency compounds with each procurement cycle that defaults to the most compelling external offer. Bonduki identified cross-governmental knowledge sharing and support for domestic open-source infrastructure as areas where philanthropic investment addresses gaps that public funding is structurally not positioned to fill.³³ The Chile comparison is a description of the trajectory Brazil is currently on. The window to interrupt it has not yet closed, but it is narrowing.

Taken together, these five constraints describe Brazil's current trajectory. The recommendations in this report are designed around the window that still exists to redirect it.

²⁹ Interview with senior official, National Data Protection Authority (ANPD), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 3, 2026.

³⁰ Thiago Camargo, Executive Vice President, InvestSP, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 19, 2026.

³¹ Correa et al., "Reimagining AI in Latin America: Situated Narratives of Users, Developers, and Decision-Makers on Understanding and Governing AI," *Communication and Change* 1, no. 12 (2025), <https://doi.org/10.1007/s44382-025-00012-1>

³² Ibid.

³³ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

The Election Year Constraint

Brazil's 2026 general election is the most important contextual factor governing the recommendations that follow in this report.

In the midst of a “race to be the face” of AI in Brazil, both major political parties have staked claims to AI regulation, which has generated a lot of political energy but very little institutional follow-through. The AI Bill will most likely not advance to implementation in 2026, as confirmed by Sampaio, who described the legislation as technically complex and politically difficult to finalize,³⁴ and reinforced by the ANPD interviewee, who noted that the institution is currently in a consolidation and growth phase rather than an enforcement posture.³⁵ The obvious consequence is that any initiative requiring formal government partnership, policy implementation, or regulatory enforcement will not produce meaningful results before the next electoral cycle.

The MEC context adds a more specific dimension. Bonduki noted that Minister Camilo Santana's departure from MEC for a presidential campaign meant that MEC's three major AI initiatives – the Referencial, EducaDados, and the EducaLab sandbox – were launched in concentrated succession in the period before his exit. While these initiatives are substantive and suggest institutional commitment, Bonduki conceded that their timing reflected political incentives even more than institutional readiness, and their sustainability depends on continuity that an election year cannot guarantee.³⁶

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA

Near-term investments – those actionable immediately – require insulation from electoral volatility. This means anchoring in civil society organizations, academic institutions, and training programs capable of operating independently of government partnership and producing durable outputs regardless of which administration takes office.

Longer-term investments that require government engagement are viable investment targets as well, but should be structured more as positioning investments in the immediate

³⁴ Marianna Sampaio, São Paulo Legislative Assembly, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 19, 2026.

³⁵ Interview with senior official, National Data Protection Authority (ANPD), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 3, 2026.

³⁶ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

future, with deployment contingent on post-election political stability. BRAVA's operating model as an intermediary funder is well-suited to navigate this constraint.

Primary Research New Insights

The SIPA team's secondary research produced a strong landscape analysis, which was both sharpened and complicated by primary interviews. These insights reveal a causal structure that changes what kinds of investments will and will not work.

- **Governance failure is cultural, not just structural.** Sampaio and Bonduki independently confirmed that Brazil's public sector treats digital transformation as a technology problem, not a leadership challenge. This framing prevents governance literacy from building at the top. Into that vacuum, vendors move. Capacity-building that targets technical skills without addressing leadership culture will not produce durable change.^{37,38}
- **Vendor capture is an operational reality.** Bonduki from inside MEC: whoever presents the most compelling offer first effectively determines what gets built.³⁹ The subnational gap makes this worse — each secretariat makes procurement decisions alone, without shared standards or the benefit of what other municipalities have learned.
- **The pandemic created latent coordination infrastructure.** The decision not to coordinate a national pandemic response forced Brazilian states to develop independent coordination capacity they had not previously had. States now have demonstrated willingness to work with one another that did not exist before 2020. Well-designed investments can activate this rather than build from scratch.
- **Civil society lacks access, not just funding.** ANPD: organizations frequently lack the resources to attend the conferences and forums where AI governance decisions are actually shaped.⁴⁰ Absence from those rooms is as disabling as being underfunded.

³⁷ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

³⁸ Marianna Sampaio, São Paulo Legislative Assembly, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 19, 2026.

^{38,39} Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

^{39,40} Interview with senior official, National Data Protection Authority (ANPD), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 3, 2026.

⁴⁰ Ibid.

- **The pilot trap is systemic.** Named independently by Sampaio, Bonduki, Cintra, and Miranda. Well-designed initiatives that cannot scale because they were never connected to the governance and infrastructure systems they would need to grow.

"I think funding is one of the biggest gaps we face. There is a lot of difficulty in getting money to organizations that are actually on the front lines of the problem. What we see is that larger intermediary organizations provide capacity building, but do not pay people."

— Laryssa Nunes, *Instituto Decodifica*

Intervention Modalities

The constraint analysis and primary research together point toward three intervention areas where BRAVA can most effectively shape the conditions for responsible and scalable public-interest AI. Section 5 provides a full scoring analysis of specific partners within each modality. **These are not parallel options; they reflect the minimum conditions required for AI oriented to the public interest to scale.**

MODALITY 1 Institutional Capacity & Technical Assistance	MODALITY 2 Data Governance & Public Infrastructure	MODALITY 3 Civil Society & Oversight Strengthening
This modality targets the gap between regulatory ambition and operational execution. It speaks to the primary need being governance literacy and leadership capacity, particularly at the subnational level, and a baseline level of strategic “AI fluency” that reduces exposure to vendor capture at the institutional level. BRAVA’s historical investments in Insper and IMPA Tech establish direct credibility in this space, and the investment logic here is a natural extension of what BRAVA already does well.	This modality targets the foundational interoperability gap that limits the reliability and scalability of any AI deployment built on top of Brazil’s current fragmented data systems. BRAVA’s role here may best be catalytic rather than operational, supporting partner-led initiatives anchored in credible research/regulatory institutions, and designed on open-source, modular principles that multiple actors can build upon, rather than attempting to own or build infrastructure directly.	This modality targets the accountability gap created by Brazil’s underdeveloped independent oversight ecosystem. This modality allows BRAVA to strengthen democratic accountability mechanisms without engaging in partisan activity, by anchoring investments in technically credible, politically neutral organizations that can provide the external examination that government and industry AI deployments currently lack.

Evaluation Framework & Good Governance

4



Overview & Approach

To create a framework defining good governance across the previously identified pillars, the SIPA team assessed multiple international frameworks and LATAM use cases to identify key factors required to demonstrate excellence across these pillars. This involved a two-step approach, including the following:

1. **Literature Review:** Conducted an academic overview of global best practice frameworks such as the OECD, WEF, UNESCO, to identify core pillars of AI governance. These findings informed the below definitions of excellence across these pillars
2. **Case Study Analysis:** Researched real-world use cases to demonstrate how these frameworks function in practice. Analysis focused on the Brazilian landscape, evaluating how these global standards align with BRAVA Foundation's strategy and pending national legislation

Following the creation of this framework, the SIPA team utilised key learnings from this secondary research, internal in-depth interviews (IDIs) with the BRAVA team, and insights from external IDIs to formulate an evaluation framework to assess potential investments and partnerships against. The criteria have been divided into two categories: core (non-negotiable) criteria, and supporting criteria. Potential partnerships will first be assessed against core criteria, as an initial screening stage. Only opportunities fulfilling the core criteria requirements, will proceed to a secondary scoring stage, where they will be evaluated against the supporting criteria to assess their overall suitability.

Framework Overview

Drawing on OECD, WEF, UNESCO, U.S. GAO, Oxford Insights, and the Responsible AI Institute, this framework identifies six pillars essential for responsible AI governance in Brazil for AI in the public interest.

Each pillar is grounded in international research, translated into actionable governance criteria, and illustrated with a Brazilian or regional use case. Together they demonstrate that good AI governance requires proactive design, democratic participation, enforceable accountability, and ongoing monitoring — technical sophistication alone is insufficient.

I. Equity & Inclusive Access

Move beyond compliance measures for non-discrimination and toward proactive, equity-centered design. Build infrastructure for underserved regions, embed equity from the design phase through deployment, and monitor outcomes using disaggregated data. Participatory governance ensures marginalized communities shape — not merely receive — AI solutions.

Use case: ITS Rio & DPRJ — AI tool addressing 500,000+ pending healthcare access cases using a multi-sector 'Operational AI Sandbox' with PretaLab (Black women in tech) as core design partners.⁴¹

II. Transparency

Multi-layered disclosure across fiscal, technical, and user-facing dimensions. Open-source components, searchable public registries, individual explanation rights, and plain-language communication alongside technical documentation throughout the AI lifecycle.

Use case: Brazil's Supreme Court VICTOR system — refusal to disclose costs or code violated democratic accountability and directly informed transparency provisions in PL 2338/2023.⁴²

III. Accountability & Democratic Oversight

Clear responsibility at every lifecycle stage. Independent oversight bodies with real investigative authority — not advisory roles. Accessible redress mechanisms, democratic participation in deployment decisions, and meaningful consequences for failures.

Use case: Coalizão Direitos na Rede — 55-organisation coalition secured mandatory risk assessments, facial recognition restrictions, and genuine civil society voice in governance.⁴³

⁴¹ "AI Development Model for the Brazilian Justice Ecosystem," Institute for Technology and Society (ITS Rio), accessed March 4, 2026, <https://itsrio.org/en/projetos/ai-development-model-for-the-brazilian-justice-ecosystem/>

⁴² Marlus H. D. M. Evangelista, et al., "LegalAnalytics: Bridging Visual Explanations and Workload Streamline in Brazilian Supreme Court Appeals," *Artificial Intelligence and Law* (July 2025), <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s10506-025-09446-w>

⁴³ "Brazil," The Essex AI Policy Observatory for the World of Work (E-AIPOWW), accessed March 4, 2026, <https://www.essex.ac.uk/research-projects/ai-policy-observatory-for-the-world-of-work/national-and-regional-cases/brazil>

IV. Institutional Capacity & Readiness

Simultaneous investment in infrastructure, skills, governance frameworks, and adaptive capabilities. Requires national strategies, dedicated institutions, workforce training, and iterative learning across national, regional, and sector levels — no single intervention suffices.

Use case: EMBRAP II AI Network — 11 specialised applied research centres across health, agriculture, smart cities, and industry, supporting 127 AI startups since 2022.⁴⁴

V. Public Value

AI success is measured by citizen wellbeing, not efficiency alone. Stakeholder-defined value spans effectiveness, equity, satisfaction, and rights protection. Includes willingness to discontinue systems that fail the public interest despite technical performance.

Use case: Colombia's Pretor IA — citizen concerns led the Constitutional Court to completely redesign the system, prioritising explainability over technical sophistication.⁴⁵

VI. Youth & Social Well-being

Rights-based framework with child impact assessments, age-appropriate design, and enhanced privacy protections. Meaningful youth participation — not just protection from harm. Proactive safeguards against exploitation, manipulation, and AI-generated harmful content.

Use case: SaferNet Brasil — peer-to-peer programme reaching 215,000 students; 71,867 CSAM reports handled in 2023, with active teen consultation on GenAI risks.⁴⁶

KEY INSIGHT

All six pillars converge on the same conclusion — good AI governance in Brazil requires proactive design, participatory processes, enforceable legal frameworks, and ongoing monitoring. Technical sophistication is insufficient without democratic legitimacy, institutional capacity, and accountability mechanisms that impose real consequences on developers and deployers alike.

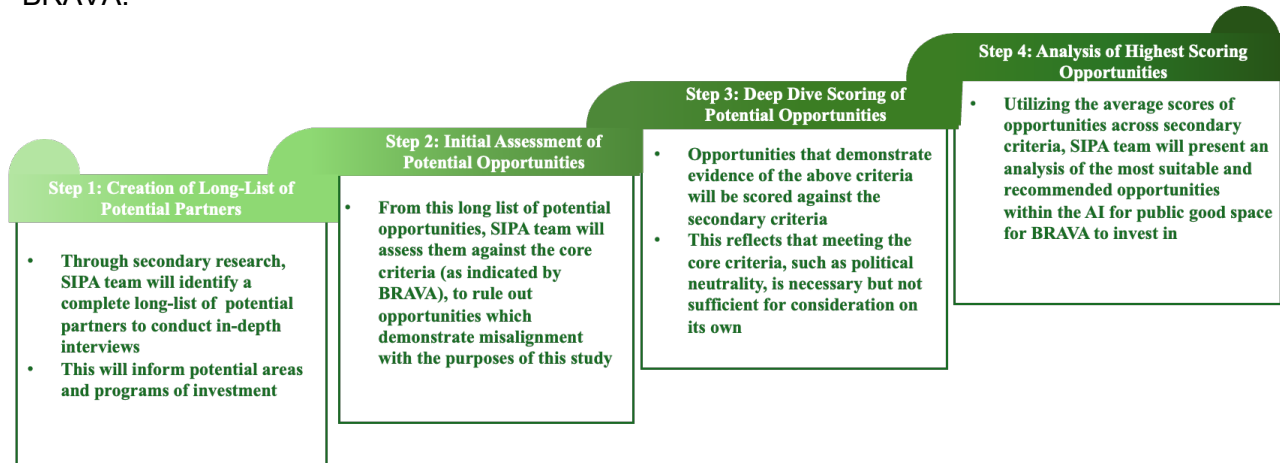
⁴⁴ “Inteligência Artificial,” EMBRAP II (Empresa Brasileira de Pesquisa e Inovação Industrial), accessed March 4, 2026, <https://embrapii.org.br/unidades-embrapii/inteligencia-artificial/>

⁴⁵ Ricardo Zapata, “Artificial Intelligence in the Latin American Public Sector,” *Medium*, June 18, 2020, <https://medium.com/@rzapata/artificial-intelligence-in-the-latin-american-public-sector-3941f212cc69>

⁴⁶ “SIC+ Programme: Brazil - SaferNet Brasil,” Better Internet for Kids, accessed March 4, 2026, <https://better-internet-for-kids.europa.eu/en/sic/brazil>

Evaluation Framework Process

To assess and score the identified potential partners, the SIPA team proposes the following tiered approach to ensure a comprehensive and structured process for identifying relevant partners for BRAVA.



Potential partnerships are first assessed against **core criteria** as an initial screening stage. Only opportunities fulfilling core criteria requirements proceed to the secondary scoring stage, where they are evaluated against **supporting criteria** to assess overall suitability.

Scoring Criteria

CORE CRITERIA (NON-NEGOTIABLE)

As mentioned previously, the scoring will follow a tiered and weighted approach, ensuring due priority is given to the required elements, while adopting a comprehensive approach. The initial screening stage include the following criteria⁴⁷:

- **Strategic Alignment:** Evaluates the alignment of the partners, and program with BRAVA's core mission, vision, and priorities.

⁴⁷ Leticia Piccoloto Ferreira, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, February 19, 2026; Evelyn Hirose, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, February 12, 2026; Mariana Soares, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, February 12, 2026

- **Political Neutrality:** Considers political neutrality, independence from partisan affiliation, and ability to operate credibly across administrations

SUPPORTING CRITERIA

Supporting criteria are derived from the governance pillars and their best practices, along with insights from BRAVA IDIs. They prioritize the most important elements required to ensure good governance and assess alignment with BRAVA's mission for programs focused on AI for public good. Leveraging the key takeaways outlined in the earlier section of good governance pillars, the team has derived scoring definitions for each criterion, ensuring a consistent approach.

Supporting criteria are defined at two levels: program-level and partner-level, allowing for a comprehensive analysis of the investment and partnership opportunity.

Below is the proposed scoring matrix for potential investments and partnerships.

Note: *In the event information from primary and secondary sources about a program proved to be limited for specific criteria, that will be marked at a score of 1.*

	Score of 1	Score of 2	Score of 3
<i>Equality and Inclusive Access</i> Does the program include measures that promote equitable AI in Brazil?	Indicates limited evidence of basic equity measures in the program such as multilingual support, adaptive measures, and high-level bias auditing	Maintains some evidence of measures adopted in the program, such as addressing an identified structural inequality using AI, and regular bias auditing of the tool (if any)	Demonstrates strong efforts to promote equitable AI using multiple measures, such as use of AI to address structural inequalities , and inclusion of equity considerations into program design or governance
<i>Transparency</i> Does the program include transparency measures for use of AI systems or AI-related advocacy?	Indicates limited evidence of basic transparency measures such as a high-level public disclosure statement of AI utilization	Maintains some evidence of in-built transparency measures, such as public disclosure of AI utilization, regular publishing of activity reports and data	Demonstrates inclusion of multiple transparency measures for AI systems such as disclosure of code/ decision logic and clear explanations of AI-sourced decisions for affected users
<i>Accountability and Democratic Oversight</i> Does the program include accountability measures for use AI systems or AI-related advocacy?	Indicates limited to no evidence of inbuilt accountability measures for stakeholder redressal, AI use accountability processes and AI advocacy commitments	Maintains some evidence of accountability measures such as disclosure of AI use, deployment oversight processes, progress on AI advocacy commitments	Demonstrates inclusion of multiple measures such as clear responsibility structures, AI use and deployment oversight , clearly structured stakeholder redressal mechanisms, and participatory data collection and advocacy approaches
<i>Building Institutional & Social Capacity</i> Does the program include objectives to build institutional and social capacity for responsible AI use?	Indicates limited engagement with only one of the following thematic areas : building institutional capacity and readiness, building public value and supporting youth education and wellbeing	Maintains limited engagement with only two of the following thematic areas : building institutional capacity and readiness, building public value and supporting youth education and wellbeing	Demonstrates strong engagement with all the following thematic areas: building institutional capacity and readiness, building public value and supporting youth education and wellbeing
<i>Financial Sustainability</i> Does the program demonstrate financial viability, and room for co-funding opportunities?	Indicates limited to no evidence of opportunities for scaling up and co-funding, with an unclear investment to impact ratio	Maintains some evidence of opportunity for scaling up, however the ratio of investment to impact appears moderate , and in some cases unclear	Demonstrates strong opportunities for scaling up , and sustained impact, likely drawing interest for co-funding opportunities with existing partners and other organizations
<i>Technical Capability and Track Record</i> Does the partner demonstrate technical capability and credibility?	Indicates limited to no evidence of technical capability , with a limited track record, which may reflect that the organization is in its early stages	Maintains some evidence of technical expertise, with limited experience of projects in the AI domain	Demonstrates clear technical competence , with a strong track record of previous programs leveraging AI , or working towards advancing public good
<i>Institutional Strength</i> Does the partner demonstrate organizational stability, operational credibility, and transparency?	Indicates limited to no evidence of clear governance structures, and vague output and outcome indicators for BRAVA to track and monitor	Maintains some evidence of clear governance structures, with nascent organization around AI , governance and accountability within the company	Demonstrates strong and clear governance structures , with clearly defined output and outcomes indicators, along with relevant milestone timelines

Program level criteria

Partner level criteria

Criteria Weightage

Supporting criteria are defined at two levels: program-level and partner-level. Scores for each criteria are weighted, with program-level criteria accounting for 80% of total score, and partner-level criteria accounting for 20%. This approach ensures that appropriate weightage is being given to BRAVA's priorities for investing in initiatives for public interest AI.

	Supporting Criteria	Weightage for Total Average Score
Partner Level Criteria (20%)	Institutional Strength	10%
	Technical Capability	10%
Program Level Criteria (80%)	Financial Sustainability	10%
	Building Institutional and Social Capacity for Responsible AI	35%
	Accountability and Democratic Oversight	10%
	Transparency	10%
	Equity and Inclusive Access	15%

Analysis & Scoring of Partners

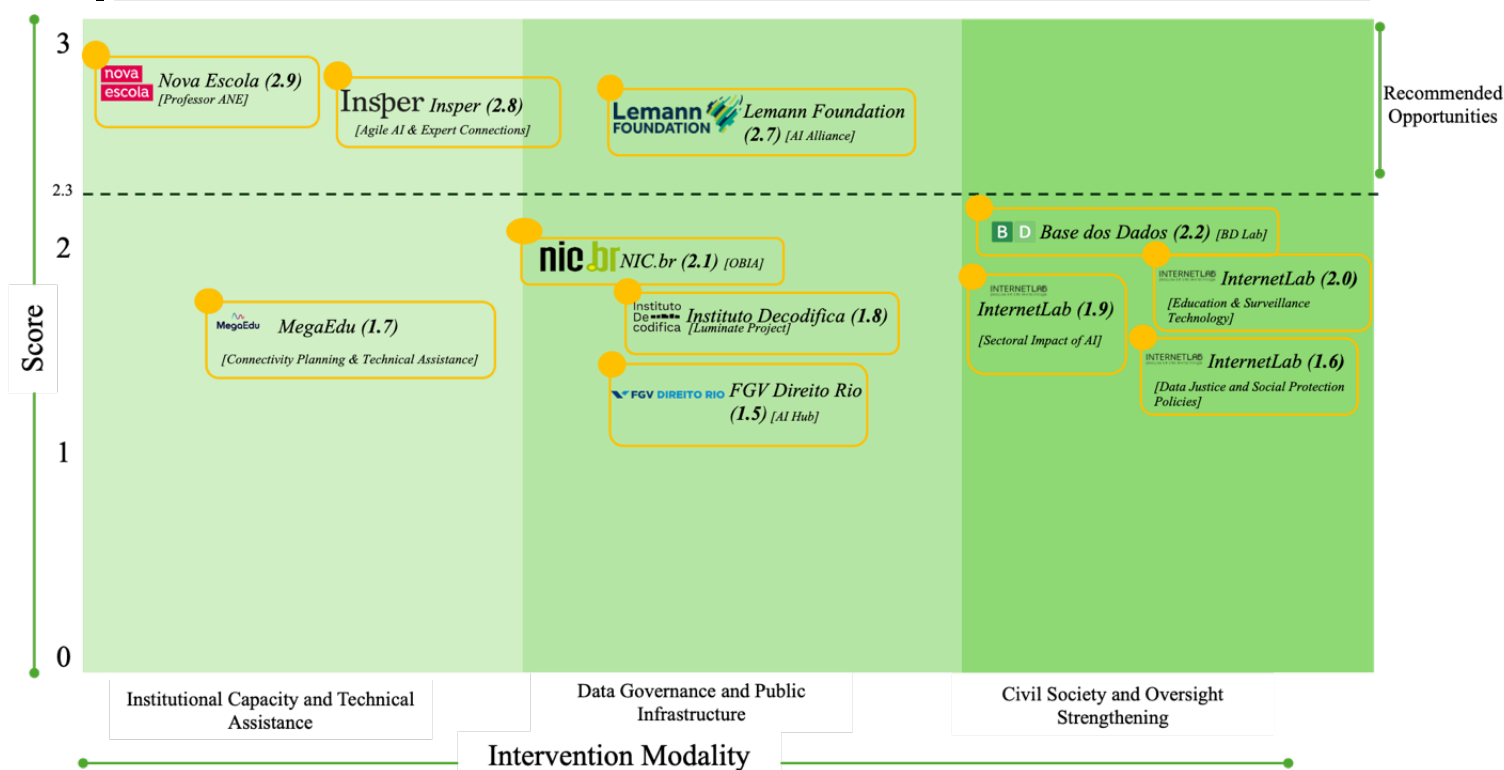
Potential Investment Opportunities



SECTION 5

Analysis & Scoring of Partners – Potential Investment Opportunities

Introduction & Overview:



The SIPA team assessed 9 entities and their programs against the evaluation framework to identify the most appropriate investment opportunities for BRAVA. These companies were also assessed against our defined intervention modalities: (1) building institutional capacity and technical assistance; (2) strengthening data governance and public infrastructure; and (3) supporting civil society and oversight strengthening.

Each entity and their programs were initially assessed for their political neutrality and strategic alignment with BRAVA's goals, before they were scored against seven key criteria. The following sub-section includes an overview about each opportunity and its program objectives.

Institution and Program Overview:

Intervention Modality 1: Institutional Capacity and Technical Assistance

ORGANIZATION: NOVA ESCOLA

A Brazilian nonprofit with nearly 40 years of history supporting public school teachers, Nova Escola operates a digital platform reaching 2 million monthly visitors and 800,000 subscribed users across all 26 states in Brazil. It is one of Brazil's most scaled education-focused civil society organizations.⁴⁸

PROGRAM:

Professor ANE - WhatsApp AI Lesson Planner: Launched in February 2025, Professor ANE is a free AI-powered lesson-planning tool embedded in WhatsApp, designed specifically for mobile use in low-connectivity environments, including rural and remote regions. In its first year, 120,000 public school teachers used the tool to generate differentiated, curriculum-aligned lesson plans through a conversational AI interface, with a localized version now being deployed in partnership with municipal and state Secretariats of Education, connecting teacher interactions directly to student assessment data.⁴⁹

ORGANIZATION: INSPER

Founded in 1970 and formally established as a private, not-for-profit institution in São Paulo, Insper is one of Brazil's most technically credible academic institutions working at the intersection of AI, industry, and public sector engagement.

PROGRAM:

Agile AI & Expert Connections: Insper's Agile AI program embeds students in real-world client projects, including civil society organizations and major Brazilian banks, where they deliver functional AI-built products before completing formal software architecture training, bridging academic AI capacity

⁴⁸ Patrick J. McGovern Foundation, "As AI Transforms Education, Nova Escola Is Empowering Teachers in Brazil to Lead the Way," Medium, February 14, 2025, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://medium.com/patrick-j-mcgovern-foundation/as-ai-transforms-education-nova-escola-is-empowering-teachers-in-brazil-to-lead-the-way-9fb36c5c90bf>

⁴⁹ Ana Ligia Scachetti, interview by SIPA team, *Nova Escola*, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 20, 2026

and real-world public-sector needs.⁵⁰ The expert connections program connects students with external partners, including foundations like Brava, producing applied AI solutions within a structured sprint model.⁵¹

ORGANIZATION: MEGAEDU

Founded in 2022, MegaEdu is a Brazilian nonprofit dedicated to closing the digital infrastructure gap in public education, working to ensure that every one of Brazil's 140,000 public schools has access to high-quality internet connectivity and education management systems, scaling from 9,000 connected schools at founding to 90,000 today, impacting approximately 10 million students across all regions of Brazil.⁵²

PROGRAM:

Connectivity Planning & Technical Assistance: MegaEdu operates through two core levers, advocacy and research, including a national roadmap mapping all 140,000 public schools and their connectivity needs, and free technical consultancy to states and municipalities, through which it has partnered with 10 states and over 150 municipalities to develop sustainable connectivity plans.⁵³ A WhatsApp-based connectivity planning tool developed by MegaEdu was recognized as the best product for closing Brazil's digital divide in 2023, and the organization is now expanding into school management systems covering teacher allocation, attendance, and student performance tracking, the data foundation that meaningful AI deployment in public schools requires.⁵⁴

⁵⁰ Fabio Roberto de Miranda, interview by SIPA team, *Inspere*, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 18, 2026

⁵¹ Ibid.

⁵² Thomaz Galvão, interview by SIPA Team, *MegaEdu*, virtual interview, April 13, 2026

⁵³ Ibid.

⁵⁴ Ibid.

Intervention Modality 2: Data Governance and Public Infrastructure

ORGANIZATION: INSTITUTO DECODIFICA

A data-driven NGO focused on marginalized communities in Brazil, Instituto Decodifica produces and analyzes citizen-generated data to support advocacy, public debate and more inclusive policy development. The organization aims to promote social transformation through accurate data collection and advocacy on behalf of marginalised communities.⁵⁵

PROGRAM:

Luminate Project: Currently in its planning phase⁵⁶, the program focuses on AI, digital inclusion exclusion and community sovereignty, looking to gather data on how the adoption of technologies disproportionately impacts marginalized communities in Brazil. The project focuses on their citizen-generated methodology to collect data for advocacy for fairer practices and policies on digital governance and technological inclusion.⁵⁷

ORGANIZATION: FGV DIREITO RIO

Founded in 2002⁵⁸ FGV Direito Rio is a law school in Rio de Janeiro, focused on providing a comprehensive legal education through collaborative teaching methods, impact research and a large network of international partners. The university has hosted over 900 undergraduate and graduate students since its founding.⁵⁹

PROGRAM:

AI Hub: The AI Hub is a research initiative that aims to produce impact-focused research on artificial intelligence regulation and responsible use, specifically in academia and the public sector in Brazil. The project aims to support reducing social inequalities which may be reinforced through the adoption of AI

⁵⁵ Instituto Decodifica. "Apresentação." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://decodifica.org/apresentacao/>

⁵⁶ Laryssa Nunes, email to SIPA Team, March 20, 2026

⁵⁷ Laryssa Nunes and Claudio Mendes, interview by SIPA team, *Instituto Decodifica*, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 16, 2026

⁵⁸ FGV Direito Rio. "Institutional." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://direitorio.fgv.br/en/school#aba-institutional>

⁵⁹ FGV Direito Rio. "School." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://direitorio.fgv.br/en/school>

and other advanced technologies⁶⁰, by providing studies and support to existing regulatory authorities such as ANDP through their Data and AI regulations research group.⁶¹

ORGANIZATION: LEMANN FOUNDATION

Founded in 2002, the Lemann Foundation drives social change by guaranteeing access to high-quality public education for Brazilians of all backgrounds and supporting the development of leaders committed to the social transformation of Brazil. They operate across two core pillars: public education and leadership development, with a concentrated portfolio of core partners, board-level engagement, and a ten-year strategic plan through 2031.⁶²

PROGRAM:

AI Alliance: The AI Alliance is a formal co-funding structure that assesses and grants funding to AI initiatives focused on public education in Brazil, with a current pipeline of nearly 80 assessed solutions and active investments in mathematics assessment and tutoring tools, including Khanmigo, Khan Academy's AI-powered chatbot currently being piloted in Brazilian public schools.⁶³ The Alliance's investment thesis centers on three areas: student tutoring, mathematics assessment, and teacher support systems, and is complemented by Lemann's parallel work on Digital Public Infrastructure, management systems, and open dataset construction as the data foundation that effective AI in education requires.⁶⁴

⁶⁰ Fundação Getulio Vargas Direito Rio, "AI Hub – Artificial Intelligence," accessed April 16, 2026, <https://direitorio.fgv.br/en/research/ai-hub-artificial-intelligence>

⁶¹ Fundação Getulio Vargas Direito Rio, "Data and AI Regulations," accessed April 13, 2026, <https://direitorio.fgv.br/en/research/data-and-ai-regulations>

⁶² Jorge Paulo Lemann, "Our Founder," Lemann Foundation, accessed April 15, 2026, <https://fundacaolemann.org.br/en/our-founder/>

⁶³ Tiago Maluta, interview by SIPA team, *Lemann Foundation*, virtual, April 6, 2026

⁶⁴ Guilherme Cintra, interview by SIPA team, *Lemann Foundation*, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 17, 2026

ORGANIZATION: NIC.BR /CETIC.BR

Founded in 2005, NIC.br is a Brazilian nonprofit responsible for managing the .br internet domain, using the revenue generated from domain registrations to fund its mission of improving internet development in Brazil, a uniquely self-sustaining model that operates independently of donor cycles or government appropriations.⁶⁵ Cetic.br is the research department that has produced internet and technology adoption indicators for over 20 years, running six regular ICT surveys across enterprises, governments, schools, and individuals, with AI-specific indicators introduced as early as 2020.⁶⁶

PROGRAM:

OBIA: Brazilian Artificial Intelligence Observatory: Launched in September 2024 as a flagship initiative of Brazil's National AI Strategy, OBIA is a public, open-access repository co-led by NIC.br and Brazil's Ministry of Science, Technology, and Innovation, aggregating AI statistics, research center data, publications, and policy documents across four strategic dimensions: government, health, education, and economic sectors, in alignment with global best practices established by ITU, UNESCO, IRCAI, and the OECD.⁶⁷ Supported by 11 AI research centers and 240 million reais in secured public and private investment through 2030, OBIA aims to become Brazil's definitive benchmark for reliable, comprehensive AI knowledge to inform policy, strategy, and responsible AI development.⁶⁸

⁶⁵ Manuella Maia Ribeiro, interview by SIPA team, *NIC.br*, virtual interview, March 27, 2026

⁶⁶ Ibid.

⁶⁷ Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, "OBIA, the Brazilian AI Observatory," Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://indicelatam.cl/obia-the-brazilian-ai-observatory/>

⁶⁸ Ibid.

Intervention Modality 3: Civil Society and Oversight Strengthening

ORGANIZATION: INTERNETLAB

Founded in 2014, InternetLab is an independent, non-profit think tank in São Paulo, conducting research at the intersection of human rights and digital technologies. It primarily focuses on assessing how state and private sector decisions impact the digital environment and its implications for democracy and social justice. Projects are usually designed to produce evidence-based policy analysis aimed at informing public debate and policymaking.⁶⁹

PROGRAM:

1. **Sectoral Impacts of AI:** Launched in 2024, the project is conducted with support from Betty & Jacob Lafer Institute. The project aims to examine the sectoral impact of generative AI across culture, education and the rights of children. The study focuses on analysing ethics, legal and sociocultural concerns linked to AI use.⁷⁰
2. **Data Justice and Social Protection Policies:** Launched in 2024, the project is conducted in partnership with Privacy International and University of St.Gallen. It aims to examine the use of algorithms and automated decision-making in Brazil's Unified Registry (CadÚnico). The project analyses the impact of automation in benefit allocation on privacy, social rights, and existing disparities on policy and governance of digital social protection systems.⁷¹
3. **Education and Surveillance Technologies:** Launched in 2023, this project is an ongoing partnership with Privacy International. The project aims to map the adoption of facial recognition and predictive technologies across Brazilian public schools, analysing their implementation and policy justifications. The project assesses the risks related to surveillance, bias, and data governance, for advocacy on the regulation and use of education technologies.⁷²

⁶⁹ InternetLab. "About." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/en/about/>

⁷⁰ InternetLab. "Impactos setoriais da IA: agenda emergente em cultura, educação e direitos das crianças e adolescentes." Accessed April 16, 2026.

<https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/impactos-setoriais-da-ia-agenda-emergente-em-cultura-educacao-e-direitos-das-criancas-e-adolescentes/>

⁷¹ InternetLab. "Justiça de dados e políticas de proteção social no Brasil: algoritmos e decisões automatizadas no CadÚnico."

Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/justica-de-dados-e-politicas-de-protecao-social-no-brasil-algoritmos-e-decisoes-automatizadas-no-cadunico/>

⁷² InternetLab. "EdTech – Tecnologias de vigilância e educação." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/edtech-tecnologias-de-vigilancia-e-educacao/>

ORGANIZATION: BASE DOS DADOS

A Brazilian nonprofit that organizes and standardizes fragmented government datasets across education, health, elections, and public finance into a single open public data lake, providing the data infrastructure that responsible AI deployment in Brazil depends on.

PROGRAM:

BD Lab: BD Lab is Base dos Dados' public-sector consulting and data-engineering arm, which partners with government agencies, foundations, and civil society organizations to build data infrastructure, automated dashboards, and AI-powered tools that make public data actionable for decision-makers.⁷³ A notable current initiative is an AI chatbot developed exclusively for the Lemann Foundation that answers strategic questions about education and leadership data in the form of queries, charts, or text, directly from the organization's data lake, representing a replicable model for AI-powered data access in the public interest.⁷⁴

⁷³ Base dos dados, *Relatório de Atividades 2024* (São Paulo: Basedosdados, 2024), accessed April 13, 2026, <https://storage.googleapis.com/basedosdados-website>

⁷⁴ Ibid.

Recommended Investment Opportunities

The SIPA team assessed each potential investment opportunity against the evaluation framework to identify highest scoring programs for BRAVA. Programs which scored an average of 2.3 and above were considered for further recommendations. The highest scoring partnerships spanned two modalities: building institutional capacity and technical assistance and strengthening data governance & public infrastructure. The shortlisted opportunities include previous partners such as the Lemann Foundation and Insper, as well as a new partnership with Nova Escola.

For additional details on scoring of all potential investment opportunities, refer to [Appendix D](#)

NOVA ESCOLA

Intervention Modality 1: Institutional Capacity and Technical Assistance

- Nova Escola presents an opportunity to build a partnership with an organization whose program is strategically aligned with BRAVA's aim of advancing public interest AI. The program aims to improve the quality of public education across Brazil by leveraging AI to support lesson planning and teaching.
- It stands out from other programs, since it engages across all three priority thematic areas: building public value, institutional capacity building and youth education and wellbeing, by providing customisable AI generated lesson plans to teachers.
- It ensures transparency and accountability are held at the highest standard, employing an LLM-as-a-judge system to evaluate AI generated content and monitoring teacher engagement continuously.
- BRAVA may support the expansion of Professor ANE's localized government-connected version, currently being piloted with select Secretariats of Education, to additional states and municipalities, funding the data integration, teacher training, and institutional partnership work required to bring the tool's full assessment-to-classroom pipeline to underserved regions where connectivity and pedagogical support are most lacking.

LEMANN FOUNDATION

Intervention Modality 2: Data Governance and Public Infrastructure

- Lemann Foundation's Artificial Intelligence Alliance for Education presents an opportunity to build further on an existing partnership relationship with a trusted and reputable partner. This program operates as a formal co-funding structure which assesses and grants funding to AI initiatives focused on public education in Brazil, with a current pipeline of ~80 assessed solutions.
- It engages across all three priority thematic areas: building institutional capacity through the AI Alliance framework which works with government at federal, state and municipal levels; building public value through open dataset strategic and digital public infrastructure investments; and supporting youth education through active AI pilots in mathematics and literacy.
- The program demonstrates a comprehensive approach to scale, designing sustainability frameworks from the beginning rather than piloting without a long-term plan. Current examples of active investments include Khanmigo - Khan Academy's AI powered chatbot.
- BRAVA may support the AI Alliance's efforts to expand its co-funding pipeline, supporting investments in assessed solutions that have demonstrated early and sustainable impact.

INSPER

Intervention Modality 1: Institutional Capacity and Technical Assistance

- Insper also provides an opportunity to capitalize on an existing partnership, to further BRAVA's goals of advancing AI for public good. The Agile AI program places students in structured sprints with civil society organizations and major financial institutions, delivering functional AI products that engage across all three priority thematic areas.
- This program indicates strong co-funding potential, with existing support from Becker Friedman Institute at the University of Chicago, and a significant investment from Tata Consultancy Services to jointly establish an AI-powered Research and Innovation Center.
- BRAVA may support this program by formally sponsoring Agile AI sprints directed at public interest challenges in the near term, such as AI tools for government transparency, social protection, or education data, while supporting Insper's ambition to open its AI platforms and curriculum models to public universities and civil society organizations across Brazil.

INTERNETLAB

Intervention Modality 3: Civil Society and Oversight Strengthening

- InternetLab's Education and Surveillance Technologies project presents an opportunity to build a new partnership with an organisation whose programs and mission are strategically aligned with BRAVA's goal of supporting public interest AI. The Education and Surveillance Technologies program assesses the risks, justifications and policies of facial recognition and surveillance technology deployment across Brazilian public schools.
- The program engages across two priority thematic areas: building public value through assessment of data collection, storage, and use policies, and supporting youth education and wellbeing through maintaining a central focus on student rights and safety.
- InternetLab demonstrates a strong track record of producing knowledge products on technology's impact on human rights, and an existing partnership with Privacy International. The methodology employed is clearly defined and denotes transparency to the target audience, strengthening the credibility, usability and scalability of its findings.
- BRAVA may support InternetLab's efforts to expand the reach and depth of this study through additional funding, alongside supporting any upcoming projects to conduct applied policy research on AI governance.

LEGEND:



Demonstrates SIPA team's recommendation, outside of the scoring matrix. InternetLab's programs demonstrate a strong alignment with BRAVA's strategic priorities. InternetLab and its project received a lower score due to reliance on limited secondary research and the absence of an interview.

Key Findings & Observations

The AI for public interest space in Brazil is still in early stages, with a few key organizations actively operating to ensure that advancing technologies are leveraged and applied with the best interest of the public in mind. During the course of our research through secondary research to identify potential partners and conducting in-depth interviews with them, SIPA team found the following key findings and observations:

Philanthropic strategy must evolve to meet the needs of organizations working in a fast evolving field: Interviews with potential partners identified consistent pressure points about how funding structures shape, and to an extent limit, the ability of organizations to create innovative, impactful programs. Organizations such as Instituto Decodifica and Nova Escola highlighted that there is a mismatch in these funding structures: primarily short-term project specific grants, leaving little room to adapt the project as the needs of the community and technology evolve, and challenges in ensuring that funding is reaching those organizations that are on the frontlines.

“

I think funding is one of the biggest gaps we face. Today, our funding comes mainly from philanthropic partners, with only one or two projects funded, but I feel there is a lot of difficulty in getting money to organizations that are actually on the front lines of the problem. What we see is that larger intermediary organizations - UN agencies, for example - provide capacity building, but do not pay people

- Laryssa Nunes, Organizational Development Coordinator at Instituto Decodifica

”

Nova Escola went on further to explain the need for funding for innovation and experimentation. Providing an example of their own project to develop an anti-racist chatbot to help teachers navigate and address racism in classrooms, they explained that the project was ultimately cancelled because the chatbot could not produce consistently reliable results on such sensitive topics within their existing financial and technical constraints. They highlighted that without risk capital that tolerates experimentation and course correction as a part of the innovation process, projects such as these struggle to get off the ground.

“

A problem we face when it comes to partnership is that funds typically go to projects that are already proven, where outcomes are predictable, leaving no money or space to innovate or test new ideas. The anti-racist chatbot is an example of something that should have been tested, but we had to give it up. Innovation is about testing, learning and sometimes giving up and building something else entirely. For us, finding space for that kind of innovation is very difficult.

- Ana Ligia Scachetti, CEO of Nova Escola

”

Foundational infrastructure gaps must be addressed alongside AI for public good:

Organizations such as MegaEdu and Base dos Dados draw attention to a more foundational concern in Brazil: equitable access to digital infrastructure. Without addressing this, attempts at ensuring equitable access to AI will remain unequal. While companies working in this field, such as Nova Escola, are cognizant of this challenge and aim to mitigate it through their programs, BRAVA may consider in the longer term to also evaluate projects that focus on bridging the gap of unequal access to digital infrastructure.

“

I do think the Brava Foundation could be a high-quality partner in supporting the implementation and delivery of quality technological infrastructure to schools — creating the ecosystem that allows AI to be used appropriately. The education sector has enormous potential, but all the security, data privacy, and governance nuances need to be thoughtfully designed in from the start. Beyond that, we should not miss the chance of reaching everyone. If we provide high-quality AI to some schools and not others, we will widen the gap.

- Thomaz Galvão, Operations Director and Co-Founder of MegaEdu

”

“

Public schools should provide students with the same quality of education regardless of where they are located. AI has the potential to make that happen at scale — but the major bottleneck in Brazil, which people do not often discuss, is infrastructure.”

- Thomaz Galvão, Operations Director and Co-Founder of MegaEdu

”

“

The 80% of students who attend public schools typically only have access to a mobile phone — sometimes one phone shared across a family, not one per child. So if they are using AI, they are using free AI, and free AI gives poorer results than paid AI. Almost everyone in Brazil is vulnerable in this sense. Perhaps 5% of the population pays for AI — the vast majority are using free tools and getting lower-quality answers that they may not even recognize as wrong.

- Ana Ligia Scachetti, CEO of Nova Escola

”

The pipeline of active programs for public interest AI continues to evolve as AI adoption matures: Highlighted during SIPA’s research, while many organizations have worked within the space, interviews and secondary research with potential partners revealed a limited number of programs aligned with BRAVA’s strategic priorities actively operating in Brazil’s AI for public good field. Several organizations such as BrazilLab, Transparencia Brasil, and LAPIN demonstrated strong examples of completed projects. To this end, BRAVA may consider engaging with these organizations in the future, though none currently have relevant active projects ongoing and secondary information on their work remains limited, making it difficult to assess their readiness for partnership at this stage.

Recommendations for BRAVA



SECTION 6 Recommendations for BRAVA

BRAVA's role as an intermediary funder is a structural advantage in Brazil's current environment — not a limitation.

Strategic Positioning

BRAVA does not deploy technology, implement and sustain end-to-end programming, or partner directly with the government. It works through civil society organizations, academic institutions, and training programs. In Brazil's current environment, that operating model is well suited for success in Brazil's current political and regulatory environment and broader ecosystem.

"Philanthropy will always be outmatched by private sector actors in terms of resources. What philanthropy can do that the private sector cannot is serve as a moral voice, a convener, and a first funder into work that the market will not touch."

— London Swift, *Principal Strategic Partnerships, Omidyar Network*

The landscape analysis established that Brazil is at an inflection point. The structural choices being made now — which vendors get embedded, which data standards get adopted, which governance frameworks enter procurement contracts — will shape the conditions all future investments operate within. **The recommendations that follow are designed around the window that still exists to redirect this trajectory.**

Near-term Investments

These are investments that can move forward now, anchored in civil society organizations, academic institutions, and training programs that operate independently of the political cycle. They are designed to generate durable impact regardless of the electoral outcome in 2026.

Longer-term Investment

This investment is viable and important, but it requires a degree of political stability and government engagement that the current environment cannot reliably provide. BRAVA can begin building the relationships and positioning needed to pursue them now, with the expectation that the ideal conditions will emerge in the post-election period.

Priority confirmed by BRAVA: Modality 1 (Institutional Capacity & Technical Assistance) is the priority entry point, with Modalities 2 and 3 as the next tier. This reflects both BRAVA's operating strengths and the causal logic the landscape analysis established.

Recommendation Logic

The near-term recommendations that follow are structured as a sequence rather than a list of options. Two of Brazil's most pressing gaps – limited governance literacy among, and limited documentation of where AI deployments are actually falling short – are closely connected. Addressing one without the other solves half the problem, which is why these investments are designed to build on and reinforce each other over time.



POST-2026 ELECTORAL CYCLE



A note on partner scoring: The partner scoring in Section 5 uses a 2.3 threshold to flag organizations with demonstrated capacity at current resource levels. That threshold works for most organizations assessed. It works less well for civil society oversight organizations, where low scores on financial sustainability reflect the funding gap the investment is designed to close — not a gap in capability. Instituto Decodifica and InternetLab both score below threshold on criteria that measure resource endowment. On methodology and accountability orientation, both score at the ceiling.

Near-Term Recommendations

REC 1 Fund applied policy research on AI governance failures in Brazil's public sector

Modality 3: Civil Society & Oversight Strengthening / Modality 1: Institutional Capacity & Technical Assistance

THE RECOMMENDATION

Invest in or co-fund a sustained applied research program that documents how AI governance is unfolding in Brazil's public sector. Specifically, examining procurement decisions, accountability structures, and data systems to understand what is working, what is not, and why. The goal is to develop findings that can be translated into practical guidance for the public managers and policymakers who need it most.

THE RATIONALE

As evidenced by the landscape analysis, Brazil has significant AI deployment activity across departments, institutions, and levels of government, yet there is not yet a credible independent body generating the evidence base that would allow institutions to learn from each other's failures. This recommendation funds that body, and as a result, generates the diagnostic foundation that makes every following investment smarter.

This surfaced across multiple stakeholder interviews. Guilherme Cintra named a specific example from Lemann's portfolio, noting that there was a well-resourced initiative that ultimately produced no transferable learning because no one was tasked with capturing it.⁷⁵ Marianna Sampaio identified the "problem diagnosis before solution deployment" failure as a systemic pattern that dedicated research capacity could directly address.⁷⁶ A valuable structural dimension added from The Omidyar Network is that "one of the most persistent failure modes in responsible technology philanthropy is the silo between grassroots organizations documenting lived harms and technical organizations building solutions."⁷⁷

⁷⁵ Guilherme Cintra, Director of Technology and Innovation, Lemann Foundation, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 17, 2026.

⁷⁶ Marianna Sampaio, São Paulo Legislative Assembly, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 19, 2026.

⁷⁷ London Swift, Principal, Strategic Partnerships, Omidyar Network, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 25, 2026.

This research feeds directly into Recommendation 2. An executive education training program can be most powerful and effective when its curriculum reflects what Brazilian practitioners need to increase the likelihood of successful outcomes. These two investments are designed to run in parallel and reinforce each other.

This is also the recommendation most directly continuous with BRAVA's existing practice. BRAVA has a demonstrated track record of funding knowledge products and applied research that shapes policy. Entering the AI governance space through research is simply an extension of what BRAVA already does well into a domain where the evidence base is underdeveloped.

BEST-POSITIONED PARTNER

InternetLab (score: 1.9) is the strongest candidate for this recommendation, specifically through its Data Justice and Social Protection Policies program. This program examines how algorithms and automated decision-making are playing out within Brazil's Unified Registry (Cadastro Único)⁷⁸ — analyzing the impact of automation on benefit allocation, privacy, social rights, and existing disparities in digital social protection systems. This makes InternetLab well-positioned to document how AI governance is unfolding in practice across procurement decisions, accountability structures, and data systems. Its existing focus on Cadastro Único also creates a natural connection to Recommendation 5, where that system serves as the anchor application domain for the longer-term data governance infrastructure investment.

EXAMPLE OUTCOMES

- At least two substantive research outputs published and in active circulation among policymakers and civil servants
- Research agenda is actively informing curriculum design for the executive education program in Rec 2
- Co-funding from at least one additional source secured for years two and three

⁷⁸ InternetLab. "Justiça de dados e políticas de proteção social no Brasil: algoritmos e decisões automatizadas no CadÚnico." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/justica-de-dados-e-politicas-de-protecaao-social-no-brasil-algoritmos-e-decisoes-automatizadas-no-cadunico/>

REC 2 Fund executive education for state and municipal public managers on AI governance

Modality 1: Institutional Capacity & Technical Assistance – highest-leverage recommendation

THE RECOMMENDATION

Invest in a short-format executive education program, structured as a one- to two-week intensive course that builds AI governance literacy among state and municipal public managers, equipping them with the tools to evaluate AI vendor claims, define and diagnose problems proactively, and exercise independent judgement over AI adoption decisions.

THE RATIONALE

This is the highest-confidence recommendation that this report will offer, with two direct government practitioner interviews explicitly noting a need for it. Marianna Samapaio named it explicitly as the “highest-leverage near-term investment available” to a philanthropic actor, describing the federal to subnational capacity differential as the “most urgent”⁷⁹ structural issue in Brazil’s AI governance ecosystem. Manuel Bonduki confirmed the constraint from inside the Ministry of Education, stating that “in the absence of governance literacy among decision-makers, vendors effectively determine what gets built.”⁸⁰ Crucially, this operating reality falls hardest at the state and municipal level where the capacity differential is most extreme.

Executive education at the subnational level is the intervention that breaks this cycle because it does three two things simultaneously: First, it addresses the root condition, which we diagnose as the governance culture challenges. Second, it produces durable human capital via trained managers who then would carry their judgment capacity across administrations and institutions. Equally valuable, this does not need to be designed from scratch. Sampaio specifically referenced the “Teaching Public Service in the Digital Age” curriculum developed by Dave Eaves at University College London as a program already adapted for the Brazilian context.⁸¹ The convenience of having a plug-and-play starting point makes this recommendation feasible as it significantly reduces design risk and time to deployment.

⁷⁹ Marianna Sampaio, São Paulo Legislative Assembly, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 19, 2026.

⁸⁰ Manuel Bonduki, Senior Innovation Adviser, Ministry of Education (MEC), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 2026.

⁸¹ <https://www.teachingpublicservice.digital/>

BEST-POSITIONED PARTNER

Both Samapaio and Bonduki pointed to Insper (score: 2.8) as the natural delivery vehicle, given its existing relationship with BRAVA and proven track record in public sector capacity building. The scoring analysis also confirms Insper's institutional depth for this role. Its \$50 million partnership with Tata Consultancy Services, which includes a jointly established AI Research and Innovation Center⁸², position Insper at the intersection of institutional credibility and applied AI practice that this program demands.

EXAMPLE OUTCOMES

- Pilot cohort of 30–50 state and municipal public managers has completed the program
- At least 3 participating municipalities and/or states have applied program learnings to a concrete procurement decision
- Curriculum updated at least once using findings from the parallel research program in Rec 1

REC 3 Provide multi-year institutional funding for civil society AI oversight and accountability

Modality 3: Civil Society & Oversight Strengthening

THE RECOMMENDATION

Provide multi-year institutional funding to technically credible, politically neutral civil society organizations working at the intersection of AI governance and accountability, with explicit advocacy and support for participation in the regulatory forums and multi-stakeholder processes where AI governance decisions are actively being shaped.

THE RATIONALE

This investment focuses on creating the external accountability pressure that gives institutions a reason to leverage the very capacity recommendations 1 & 2 seek to build. These two layers are

⁸² Fabio Roberto de Miranda, Program Director of the Computer Science Program, Insper, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 18, 2026.

interdependent. Research without accountability pressure produces reports and frameworks that risk remaining unread and limited in their impact; likewise, trained managers without the reinforcement of external scrutiny can contribute to a culture of reverting to “what’s easy” rather than what is right. Civil society oversight can close this loop and provide external validation of governance in practice.

A senior official at ANPD surfaced the most specific diagnosis, sharing that civil society organizations in Brazil lack not just funding, but also access. They cannot afford to attend the conferences and forums where AI governance is decided, making them absent from the processes that most need their input.⁸³ Instituto Decodifica confirmed the accountability vacuum from the community side. Claudio Mendes noted that “no meaningful redress mechanisms currently exist for populations most affected by public sector AI.”⁸⁴

Interview synthesis from Brazilian stakeholders confirms that organizations in Brazil’s third sector are already implementing best practices consistent with the good governance framework (participatory data collection, community-first advocacy, and inclusive design.) Instituto Decodifica’s citizen data generation methodology, which presents findings to affected communities for validation before taking them to policymakers, and InternetLab’s sustained track record of producing peer-recognized research on technology and human rights, both reflect methodological maturity that multi-year institutional funding would be designed to sustain and scale. Nova Escola surfaced the same structural problem from the education side, with Ana Ligia Scachetti explaining that “funds typically go to projects that are already proven, where outcomes are predictable, leaving no money or space to innovate or test new ideas.”⁸⁵ Multi-year institutional grants, rather than project-specific funding, are the tool that resolves this constraint.

Multi-year institutional grants can be the ideal instrument rather than one-off project grants. A one-year project grant to the right organization will produce less durable impact than a three-year institutional grant to a slightly less obvious one.

⁸³ Interview with senior official, National Data Protection Authority (ANPD), interview by SIPA Capstone Team, April 3, 2026.

⁸⁴ Laryssa Nunes and Claudio Mendes, interview by SIPA team, Instituto Decodifica, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 16, 2026

⁸⁵ Ana Ligia Scachetti, interview by SIPA team, Nova Escola, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 20, 2026

BEST-POSITIONED PARTNER

Base dos Dados (score: 2.2) is the strongest candidate for this recommendation. Its track record of making complex public data accessible – including an active partnership with Lemann Foundation to build Portuguese-language data infrastructure⁸⁶ – positions it well to support AI governance oversight in practice. If public data on AI outcomes from MCTI can be channeled through Base dos Dados and made accessible through publicly available tools, this creates a meaningful transparency and accountability mechanism for civil society and the broader public. Any engagement should be structured with Base dos Dados's current financial fragility in mind — its operating deficit and declining donation revenue mean that grant design should prioritize organizational stability alongside program delivery.

EXAMPLE OUTCOMES

- Funded organizations consistently present in ANPD consultations, AI Bill review processes, and relevant multi-stakeholder forums, when possible
- At least one formal submission to a policy process produced and in circulation among policymakers
- Staff retention and core program continuity maintained through year 2 without emergency funding dependency

REC 4 Support responsible AI adoption in public education with a youth well-being lens

Modality 3: Civil Society & Oversight Strengthening / Modality 1: Institutional Capacity & Technical Assistance

THE RECOMMENDATION

Invest in a civil society organization working at the intersection of AI, public education, and youth well-being to support the safe and equitable adoption of AI technologies. This organization should center positive outcomes for Brazilian youth in their approach to AI implementation in the education system, and be able to both model responsible AI deployment for teachers and

⁸⁶ Base dos dados, *Relatório de Atividades 2024* (São Paulo: Basedosdados, 2024), accessed April 13, 2026, <https://storage.googleapis.com/basedosdados-website>

students while concurrently generating the governance evidence needed to inform how Brazil regulates AI in educational contexts.

THE RATIONALE

The incorporation of the Youth & Social Well-Being pillar of our research analysis was undertaken from the close collaboration and recommendation of the BRAVA team, following from the rationale that young people are increasingly exposed to digital platforms within which AI models are embedded. Nova Escola emphasized the gap in resources available to public school teachers in Brazil with regards to the diversity of the country's regions. With regards to funding, our interviewees highlighted a lack of flexible funding for experimentation with innovative AI implementation across the social sector, creating a moment for impact on the part of BRAVA.

Thiago Lopes, Executive Vice President of Invest SP, stressed the major gap in educational outcomes between Brazilian school-aged children and global averages. Coupled with low levels of English language proficiency and the predominance of general-purpose large language models developed for many different use cases, there exists a potential for AI technology to be integrated into public education to “level the playing field” and improve long-term social well-being. This insight was further validated by Fabio Roberto de Miranda of INSPER, who highlighted education as the most important entry point into AI. Referring to his work centered on the implementation of AI within education, de Miranda highlighted a major concern in the equitable access and practical usability of AI systems, specifically in assisting people to utilize AI technologies more confidently. Note that research on fully understanding the impacts (both negative and positive) of integrating AI into different levels of education are still ongoing. For example, equipping primary school students with chatbots for homework assistance is a very different scenario than using large language models to assist in targeted discovery research in higher education. Likewise, the causality between use of AI and better outcomes is the educational context is an area of active development and tends to be very use-case specific. Any partnership or project development in the AI and education space should be mindful of these dynamics and not serve to reinforce Western foundational model company access to the data and attention economy of Brazil's students.

Nova Escola's score of 2.9 — the highest of any organization assessed — reflects institutional reach unmatched in Brazil's civil society: 40-year institution, 2M monthly website visitors, 800,000 subscribed users, annual survey of 7,000 teachers across all 26 states.

BEST-POSITIONED PARTNER

Nova Escola focuses on providing practical support for teachers and promoting equitable access to AI tools with a strong emphasis on human input and teacher-informed feedback to evaluate content. With an extensive resume of previous partnerships, Nova Escola would serve as an informed and reliable partner for BRAVA to support youth and social well-being in scholastic AI adoption.

EXAMPLE OUTCOMES

- At least one AI tool deployed in public school settings with documented human oversight mechanisms and teacher-informed governance rubrics
- At least one research output on youth AI governance produced and in circulation among policymakers
- Governance experience shared with the research program in Rec 1 as a documented case study of responsible deployment

Longer-Term Recommendations

REC 5 Support data governance and interoperability infrastructure

Modality 2: Data Governance & Public Infrastructure

THE RECOMMENDATION

When political conditions stabilize post-2026, BRAVA could consider investing in a partner-led initiative that builds reusable, “stackable” open-source data governance infrastructure. The model for this should follow the Digital Public Infrastructure Framework articulated by Guilherme Cintra and Fundação Lemann, an approach that prioritizes modular, interoperable systems designed to be build upon by many actors rather than owned by any single institution.⁸⁷ Brazil’s own payments infrastructure, PIX, is a useful reference point cited by Cintra: a federalized, open system that became foundational precisely because it was designed for shared use from the start rather than retrofitted for it later. SIPA team envisions Cadastro Único as the anchor application domain for this potential future investment.

WHY TIMING MATTERS

The near-term recommendations could serve to produce more trained public managers, stronger civil society, and a growing research base – but their impact may still be constrained by the data infrastructure those managers are overseeing. Fragmented, poorly interoperable data is the primary condition that makes vendor capture easy and accountability hard. Cadastro Unico (The Single Registry), illustrates both the progress possible and the governance gap that remains. Currently, it deploys AI algorithms for fraud detection across a system serving 28 million low-income families, operated by 40,000 professionals across every Brazilian municipality. What it lacks, however, are governance frameworks to evaluate when those algorithms are wrong or to provide redress when they harm beneficiaries.⁸⁸ Addressing this issue at scale requires the political conditions and cross-institutional commitment that this current election year cannot provide. Given this intervention modality is more technical than BRAVA’s traditional focus, a partner-led, catalytic approach makes the most sense.

⁸⁷ Guilherme Cintra, Director of Technology and Innovation, Lemann Foundation, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 17, 2026.

⁸⁸ Leticia Bartholo, “Brazil’s Single Registry: A Preparatory Phase and a New Era,” IPCid Research Brief No. 005 (Brasília: IPEA, September 2025), https://ipcid.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/IPCID_PRB005_Brazil_s_Single_Registry.pdf

WHAT BRAVA SHOULD DO NOW

Consider building a co-investment relationship with Fundacao Lemann around this investment thesis. Lemann's score of 2.7 confirms it as a natural institutional anchor for a longer-term infrastructure investment. The scoring analysis highlights Lemann's practice of joining the boards of core portfolio organizations to ensure strategic alignment, along with its explicit focus on designing for scale rather than piloting without sustainability frameworks. This directly addresses two of the most common failure modes the landscape analysis identified.

The near-term research done through Recommendation 1 should explicitly include Cadastro Unico governance as a documentation domain. This will help generate an evidence base that will make this longer-term investment more precise when the political conditions exist to pursue it. Ideally, BRAVA could begin engaging in these conversations with Lemann in the near-term so that a structure is in place when conditions change

What to Avoid

The following failure modes are drawn directly from interview findings across government, private sector, and third sector interviewees:

Solutions before diagnosis

Municipalities often cannot articulate a problem diagnosis phase before any solution is deployed. Named by Sampaio, Bonduki, and Cintra independently.

Overemphasis on federal investments

Sampaio and Bonduki expressed sentiment that federal investments frequently do not produce subnational impact. Brazil's most acute gaps are at the state and municipal level.

Scale over expertise

ANPD's own account: growing headcount did not resolve expertise gaps. Prioritize depth and practical application. More people trained is not the same as stronger governance.

Avoiding hard conversations with grantees

Omidyar Network: funders have a moral responsibility to convene and push back. Build structured check-ins and honest feedback loops into grant design from day one.

Pilots without sustainability plans

A concrete example from Lemann's own portfolio illustrates the risk: Gatopardos was a technically sound literacy software with demonstrated results, but it had no sustainability plan and no committed coalition to carry it forward. It did not survive beyond its initial funding cycle.

Only backing proven models

Nova Escola's anti-racist chatbot was a genuine public need but was shut down due to inconsistent results. There is a need for funding for deliberate, well-governed experimentation with clear guardrails.

Proposed First Move

STRONGEST CANDIDATE FOR BRAVA'S FIRST INVESTMENT:

RECOMMENDATION 2: INSPER EXECUTIVE EDUCATION PROGRAM FOR STATE AND MUNICIPAL PUBLIC MANAGERS

This is the highest-leverage recommendation in the report: it addresses the root conditions driving governance failure, anchors in an existing BRAVA relationship, is confirmed by two direct government practitioner IDs without prompting, is fully insulated from the electoral cycle, and is likely to produce durable human capital.

From a sequencing perspective, we would recommend beginning the conversation with Insper on both the executive education program (Recommendation 2) and the research program (Recommendation 1) simultaneously. These two investment opportunities are designed to reinforce each other, and Insper's position as a potential anchor for both means BRAVA can build the foundational layer of this portfolio through a single trusted relationship before expanding to the civil society and oversight layer.

Engagement Strategy



Translating strategic analysis into actual investments requires deliberate choices about how and where to deploy philanthropic capital.

The global funding landscape for public-interest AI has expanded significantly since 2022, but it is characterized by structural inefficiencies: duplication of effort, short grant cycles that strand promising pilots, and a persistent gap between the scale of private AI investment and resources directed toward governance and public benefit. BRAVA enters this space with a clear institutional identity and a distinct operating advantage: deep, trusted presence in Brazil's public sector ecosystem, a lean and agile team, and a theory of change grounded in institutional capacity rather than just technology deployment.

Grant Design

The following five dimensions draw on findings from the Omidyar Network interview, insights from civil society partners, and the broader philanthropic landscape analysis.

1. Institutional vs. project funding

The evidence from both the Omidyar Network interview and the broader funding landscape points clearly toward institutional funding as the higher-leverage entry point. When funders attach resources exclusively to discrete deliverables, organizations are forced to continuously reconstruct capacity around each grant cycle rather than building durable expertise. Research on the global AI funding landscape finds that organizations are discouraged from sharing their wins because doing so risks their funding, while funding models that reward novelty over consolidation create incentives toward duplicative new projects rather than consolidation of what works. For BRAVA, project-level grants should supplement, not substitute for, institutional investment.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Where possible, BRAVA may consider structuring grants to credible civil society and research partners as institutional or core-capacity support rather than output-specific project grants. Reserve project-level funding for well-scoped pilots with a clear pathway to scaling and knowledge transfer.

2. Grant Duration – Ideal Minimum Viable Commitment

Institutional capacity building, regulatory engagement, and civil society oversight work unfold over years, not months. Short grant cycles are convenient, but they have a cost: organizations are forced to spend time and energy on renewal processes rather than the work itself, and cannot make the longer-term hiring and relationship-building decisions that meaningful impact requires. For the kinds of investments this report recommends, a minimum of two to three years is a more appropriate commitment horizon. Shorter grants may be suitable for well-scoped pilots where evaluation criteria are clear from the outset, but they should not be the default for partners whose core contribution is building technical credibility or sustained presence in regulatory processes.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Where possible, BRAVA may consider structuring grants to civil society and research partners in the AI governance space at a minimum of two to three years. For well-scoped pilots with clear evaluation criteria, shorter timelines can work, however, the renewal process itself should not become a burden that pulls organizations away from the work. Building in structured check-in points along the way, rather than a hard endpoint, gives both BRAVA and its partners the flexibility to assess progress and adjust course without starting from scratch.

3. Flexibility on objectives

In a field moving as quickly as AI governance, grant agreements that lock organizations into fixed activity plans from the outset tend to work against the very outcomes they are trying to achieve. A more effective approach builds in the ability to adapt specific activities and timelines as the policy environment shifts, while keeping the strategic intent and accountability structures intact. This is especially relevant in Brazil's current pre-election context, where the regulatory landscape and the opportunities for civil society engagement can change quickly. Flexibility on objectives allows grantees to remain relevant and responsive throughout the life of a grant.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

BRAVA may consider designing grant agreements around strategic intent and accountability milestones rather than fixed deliverable lists. Structured check-in points at mile marks, for example, give both BRAVA and its partners the opportunity to revisit specific activities in light of what has changed, without renegotiating the underlying purpose of the investment. This approach reduces administrative burden on grantees and keeps the work responsive to the policy environment it is trying to shape.

4. Risk Appetite

Civil society organizations working at the frontier of AI governance in Brazil — developing algorithmic audit methodologies, building technical oversight capacity, engaging in regulatory consultation on emerging frameworks — are operating in a space that is pre-commercial, pre-institutional, and in many cases pre-regulatory. BRAVA's current operating philosophy represents a positioning in line with conservative funding tendencies. However, the highest-leverage civil society investments are often the ones hardest to justify on conventional grant-making criteria precisely because they are filling a gap no other funder is willing to occupy.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

BRAVA may consider consciously positioning a portion of the AI governance portfolio as risk capital: grants to credible organizations attempting work with no established precedent in Brazil. Define risk tolerance through partner selection criteria rather than deliverable specifications, and accept that some early-stage investments will not produce measurable outputs within the grant window.

5. The co-funding model – leveraging BRAVA’s ecosystem position

BRAVA does not need to (and arguably should not) fund public-interest AI in Brazil alone. The most relevant global mechanism is Current AI, the MacArthur-led initiative launched in 2025 with \$400 million in initial commitments, focused explicitly on public interest AI: open datasets, algorithmic accountability, data governance standards, and oversight tools.⁸⁹ HumanityAI (Omidyar Network and MacArthur)⁹⁰ represents a second coordination point. Analysis of the global philanthropic landscape surfaces that co-funding structures work best when they have a clear narrative for synergistic grant allocation; where the combination of funders unlocks something that no individual funder could achieve alone.

IMPLICATION FOR BRAVA:

Within Brazil, the Lemann Foundation is the most natural co-funding anchor. Its ten-year planning horizon, DPI framework expertise, and existing BRAVA relationship make it the right starting point for the longer-term infrastructure investment. Other domestic philanthropic actors with aligned interests in education, governance, and civil society strengthening are worth mapping as potential co-funders for near-term recommendations, particularly where BRAVA's AI-specific positioning complements an existing partner's sector depth. Globally, the Ford Foundation represents a co-funding opportunity where BRAVA's role is that of a Brazil-specific anchor.

⁸⁹ <https://www.macfound.org/press/grantee-news/new-partnership-to-promote-public-interest-ai>

⁹⁰ <https://www.macfound.org/press/press-releases/humanity-ai-commits-500-million-to-build-a-people-centered-future-for-ai>

Partner Relationships

"Funders who write checks and disappear, re-emerging at reporting time to evaluate outputs they were never engaged enough to understand."

— London Swift, *Principal Strategic Partnerships*, Omidyar Network

Grant design is only one piece of the puzzle. Partner relationships are equally as important and ultimately determine if the instruments selected through grant design actually work. London Swift (The Omidyar Network) named the failure mode BRAVA most needs to avoid: “funders who write checks and disappear, re-emerging at reporting time to evaluate outputs they were never engaged enough to understand.”⁹¹ It is critical that BRAVA build active stewardship into every relationship in this portfolio.

REPORTING & EVALUATION

Reporting and evaluation should be designed with the partner’s capacity at the forefront rather than BRAVA’s administrative convenience. Organizations doing frontline civil society work in a fast-moving field like AI cannot afford to spend significant staff time producing reports that don’t get read. BRAVA should set reporting requirements that are minimal, meaningful, and genuinely connected to the learning questions BRAVA is trying to answer. Rather than solely “what outputs did you produce?”, a better framing includes: “what does BRAVA need to know to be a better funder of this work?” and “what does the organization need to reflect on to keep improving?”

ACTIVE ENGAGEMENT

Active engagement means BRAVA shows up between reporting cycles. Quarterly check-ins should be the bare minimum for investments in the civil society and capacity-building layer. These conversations serve two purposes: they give BRAVA early signal on whether something is working or needs to change, and they give grantees access to BRAVA’s network at moments

⁹¹ London Swift, *Principal, Strategic Partnerships*, Omidyar Network, interview by SIPA Capstone Team, March 25, 2026.

when it is most useful. The Omidyar Network was explicit that this is where funders have the most leverage and “most consistently abdicate it.”⁹²

LEARNING LOOPS

BRAVA should identify, at the outset of each investment, the two or three questions it most needs answered by the end of the grant cycle. These questions should be strategic ones about the field, because learning loops require intentional design.

- Does executive education change procurement behavior?
- Does civil society presence in regulatory forums produce different outcomes, or does access without resources still not move the needle?

These types of questions should be shared with grantees so that the work itself is structured to generate the answers. At the end of each cycle, BRAVA should document what it learned and make that learning available to the broader philanthropic ecosystem.

POLITICAL SENSITIVITY

Political sensitivity is a structural feature of this work. Organizations doing AI accountability work in Brazil operate in proximity to government actors who often have strong incentives to prefer less accountability and scrutiny. BRAVA’s role is to protect the independence of its grantees while maintaining productive relationships with the government actors those grantees are engaging. The practical implication here is that BRAVA should not ask grantees to soften findings, mediate disputes between grantees and government partners, or use its position to smooth over accountability that should be uncomfortable. Ideally the civil society organizations that are funded have apolitical credibility and it is BRAVA’s job to treat it as such.

⁹² Ibid.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL) & Measuring Impact

The MEL framework below tracks whether investments are producing the compounding effect the sequencing logic requires. These indicators are near-term signals; meaningful impact in governance capacity building, civil society strengthening, and regulatory engagement will not be visible within a single grant cycle. Deeper impact assessment should be built into multi-year grant renewals and portfolio-level reviews.

Indicator	What it measures	Example Impact
MODALITY 1: INSTITUTIONAL CAPACITY & TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE		
Number of state/municipal public managers who complete the executive education program and can demonstrate a working framework for evaluating AI procurement decisions	Whether the program is reaching decision-makers with actual procurement authority	30–50 completions in pilot cohort - At least 2 participating municipalities apply learnings to a documented procurement decision
Number of curriculum updates driven by findings from the parallel research investment	Whether the research to training feedback loop is functioning in practice, not just in design	At least 1 curriculum revision traceable to a specific research finding within 12 months of program completion
Evidence of vendor capture shifts: # of restructured or rejected vendor proposals using program frameworks	Whether governance literacy translates into changed procurement behavior	At least 2–3 documented instances across cohort participants within 18 months of program completion

Indicator	What it measures	Example Impact
MODALITY 2: DATA GOVERNANCE & PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE		
Number of government actors formally adopting or piloting the open-source, modular data governance framework developed through BRAVA-supported infrastructure work	Whether infrastructure investments are producing reusable outputs that multiple actors build on	At least 2 government actors formally piloting the framework within 24 months of investment
Progress on Cadastro Único governance documentation: research outputs mapping algorithmic decision points, error rates, and redress gaps in the fraud detection system	Whether the near-term research program is generating the evidence base the longer-term infrastructure investment will require	At least 1 substantive research output on Cadastro Único governance published within 18 months
Co-investment confirmed: whether Fundação Lemann has committed to the infrastructure investment alongside BRAVA	Whether BRAVA has successfully used its convening role to leverage additional capital	- Co-investment conversation initiated with Lemann within 6 months - Commitment structure agreed within 18 months

Indicator	What it measures	Example Impact
MODALITY 3: CIVIL SOCIETY & OVERSIGHT STRENGTHENING		
Consistent presence of BRAVA-funded civil society organizations in ANPD consultations, AI Bill review processes, and relevant multi-stakeholder forums	Whether funding is closing the access gap, not just the resource gap	- Funded organizations present in at least 3 regulatory forums within 12 months - At least 1 formal submission to a policy process
Research outputs produced and in active circulation: findings cited in regulatory consultations, policy processes, or by other ecosystem actors	Whether civil society research is reaching the decision-makers who need it	- At least 2 research outputs published within 12 months - At least 1 finding cited in a formal policy process
Organizational stability: staff retention rates, ability to maintain core program activities without project-by-project fundraising pressure	Whether multi-year institutional grants are producing the organizational durability they are designed to create	Funded organizations maintain core team and program continuity through year 2 without significant dependency on BRAVA emergency funding

Conclusion

8

BRASIL

Brazil's public-interest AI landscape is an emerging trajectory. The five constraints this report identifies are real and compounding, but they are not yet locked in. The governance choices being made now, the vendors getting embedded, the data standards being adopted or disregarded, the oversight infrastructure being built or neglected – these will determine whether AI in Brazil's public sector generates lasting public value or reproduces and deepens existing institutional weaknesses.

BRAVA enters this space at the right moment and with the right operating model. Its identity as a domestic philanthropic institution – trusted, politically neutral, and grounded in institutional capacity rather than technology deployment – fills a glaring ecosystem need. The recommendations in this report are not designed to solve Brazil's AI governance challenges directly. They are designed to build the conditions under which those challenges become solvable: public managers who can exercise independent judgment, civil society organizations with the resources and access to hold institutions accountable, a research base that documents what is actually happening on the ground, and, over time, the data infrastructure that allows responsible AI to scale.

None of these investments operates in isolation. They are a sequence, and the sequence matters. The near-term work creates the ecosystem conditions the longer-term infrastructure investments require. The research informs the training. The training creates institutional counterparts for civil society oversight. The oversight generates the evidence base that makes future investments more precise.

The window to shape this trajectory is open. It will not remain so indefinitely. The practical sequencing this report recommends – beginning with Insper on both the executive education and research programs simultaneously – is designed to move quickly through that window while building the relational and institutional foundations that make everything else possible.

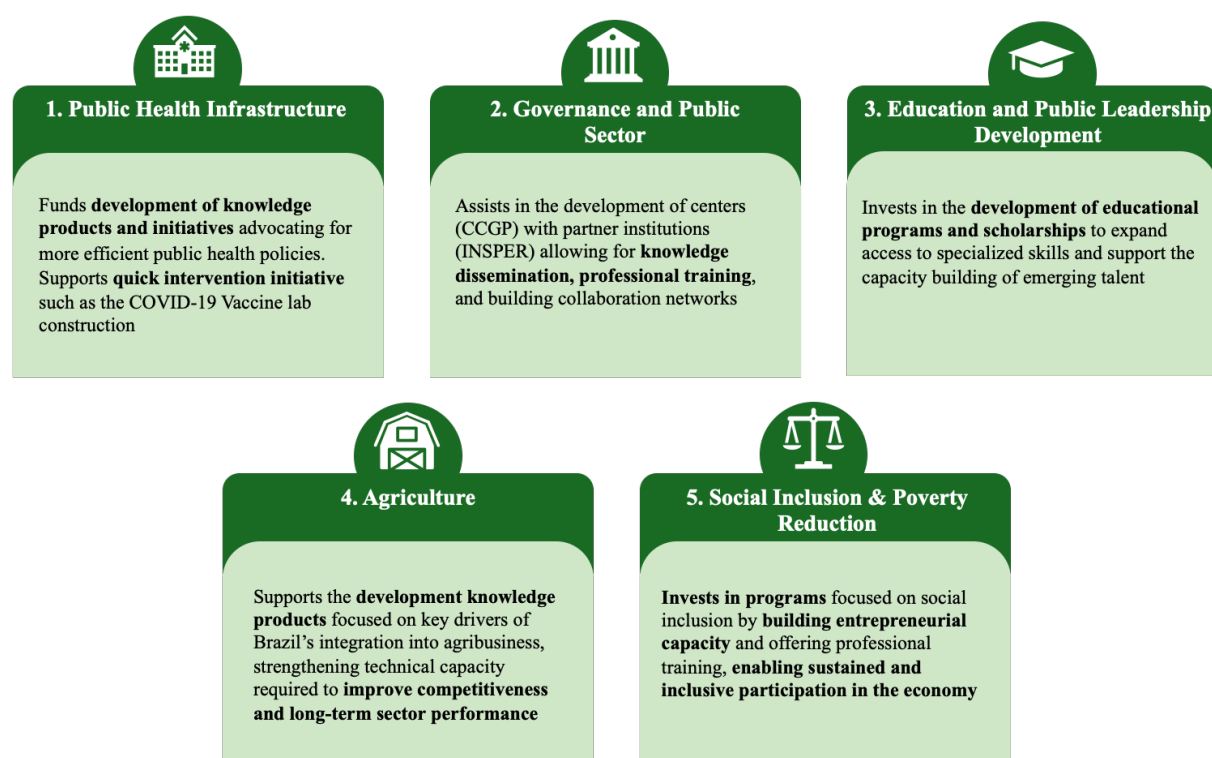
Brazil's public sector deserves AI governance infrastructure that is accountable, equitable, and built to last. BRAVA is well-positioned to help build it.

Appendix

Appendix A: BRAVA Sector Portfolio

SECTORS

BRAVA Foundation maintains a sector-agnostic approach towards its projects and partnerships, maintaining diversity across its portfolio while ensuring its projects are high-impact. BRAVA's projects have historically focused on the sectors of public health, social services, education, governance and agriculture. A notable element across projects is that BRAVA prefers to remain politically-agnostic in its approach to partnerships and project selection.



The following section summarizes BRAVA's work in segments of Brazil's public sector:

PUBLIC HEALTH INFRASTRUCTURE:

Covid Vaccine Lab: BRAVA provided funding support for the construction of a COVID vaccine lab construction and provided funding for the first 1000 vaccine trials in Brazil. **Outcomes:**

BRAVA's funding accelerated Brazil's domestic vaccine research and testing capacity at a critical moment in the pandemic. By supporting lab construction and critical trials, BRAVA contributed to strengthening national public health infrastructure and reducing reliance on external production.

Institute of Health Policy Studies (IEPS): BRAVA provided philanthropic funding and institutional support to IEPS who focus on creating knowledge products, and initiatives advocating for more efficient public health policies in Brazil. **Outcomes:** BRAVA's support to IEPS contributed to the strengthening of Brazil's evidence-based public health policy ecosystem by enabling high impact and outcome driven interventions.

GOVERNANCE/PUBLIC SECTOR:

Inspier - CGPP (Center for Public Policy Management): BRAVA launched the CGPP in 2018 with the "aims to promote informed debate on public policies, generate knowledge, train professionals, and build collaboration networks." **Outcomes:** Through the launch of CGPP, BRAVA strengthened Brazil's public policy ecosystem by expanding professional training and applied research capacity. Over time, this investment reinforces institutional capacity and improves the quality of policy formation and implementation in Brazil.

Meu Município: BRAVA incubated the Meu Município portal, a public management infrastructure that aggregates and standardizes municipal revenue and expenditure data. The portal allows users to compare how Brazilian cities collect and allocate public resources. **Outcomes:** By making complex fiscal information accessible and comparable, BRAVA strengthened local governments' analytical capacity and improved transparency for citizens. The subsequent transfer of the platform to the GovTech company Bright Cities demonstrates an institutional strategy of incubating governance tools, institutionalizing them, and transitioning them to sustainable operators.

EDUCATION + PUBLIC LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT:

Inspier: BRAVA provided philanthropic funding to the Computer Science Undergraduate Program through which 91 students were supported with scholarships. **Outcomes:** Through scholarship support for Inspier's computer science program, BRAVA contributed to expanding access to advanced technical training in a high-demand field. This investment strengthens Brazil's digital talent pipeline and increases the availability of skilled professionals contributing to public and private institutions.

IMPA Tech: BRAVA supported the first undergraduate program from IMPA, which was a partnership with the federal government that provided Bachelor's Degrees in Mathematics and Technology and Innovation. **Outcomes:** By supporting the launch of IMPA Tech's undergraduate program in Mathematics and Technology, BRAVA helped expand Brazil's capacity for advanced quantitative and technical education. This investment reinforces the country's long-term innovation ecosystem by cultivating highly trained graduates prepared to contribute to research, technology development, and institutional modernization.

GovTech Fellows Program: BRAVA provided support in the second phase of this educational program funded in partnership with other institutes providing 30 scholarships for a hybrid course for civil servants in Brazil. The project aimed to encourage innovation projects focused on sustainability, environment and reducing social inequities. **Outcomes:** Through its support of the GovTech program, BRAVA strengthened the innovation capacity of Brazilian civil servants by equipping them with technical training and applied project experience.

Renova BR: Prepares new talents for politics, provides ongoing training for elected representatives, and manages a network of individuals who have already been trained. **Outcomes:** Through its support of Renova BR, BRAVA strengthened leadership capacity within Brazil's political ecosystem by contributing to structured training and professional development for current and aspiring public officials. By investing in skills-based preparation and ongoing peer networks, BRAVA reinforced institutional competence and ethical leadership standards across the public sector. This initiative aligns with BRAVA's broader commitment to improving governance quality while maintaining political neutrality.

Cidade em Jogo (City in Play): Developed by BRAVA in partnership with the Brazil Institute at the Woodrow Wilson Center. A simulation game that places students in the role of a mayor, requiring them to make trade-offs across municipal budgets, public services, and competing political priorities. **Outcomes:** Through City in Play, BRAVA has contributed to the development of future public leaders by equipping these students with hands-on, applied understanding of governance challenges while also strengthening governance literacy in the education system.

SOCIAL INCLUSION & POVERTY REDUCTION:

Instituto da Providencia: Focused on combating poverty through productive social inclusion of vulnerable populations in Rio de Janeiro via “socio-emotional skills, professional training, and entrepreneurial capacity.” **Outcomes:** Through its support of Instituto da Providencia, BRAVA strengthened local capacity for workforce development and productive social inclusion among vulnerable populations. By investing in structured training models that build socio-emotional and professional skills, BRAVA contributed to expanding economic participation and long-term income generation.

AGRICULTURE:

Inspier - Centro Agro: Analyzed the drivers of transformation and Brazil’s integration into global agribusiness. (Of note: included a partnership with Columbia University as part of the Global Climate Challenge). **Outcome:** By supporting Inspier’s Centro Agro, BRAVA enhanced Brazil’s research and analytical capacity in agribusiness and sectoral transformation. This investment contributes to long-term sector performance and reinforces Brazil’s institutional capacity in a critical economic domain.

Appendix B: Institutional Readiness: Multi-Dimensional Assessment

OXFORD INDEX FRAMEWORK: A CAPACITY LENS

The Oxford Insights Government AI Readiness Index (2025) ranks Brazil 22nd globally with a total score of 69.55, positioning it among the strongest AI-ready governments in Latin America. We assess the strengths and constraints from a capacity lens within the AI landscape in Brazil below:

Strengths	Constraints
 Strong policy commitment and vision for AI: The country scored perfectly in Policy Commitment and highly in Policy Vision, indicating clear strategic prioritization and formal government backing. <i>We are able to confirm through research on use cases (see Public Sector AI Use) that there is high appetite for the governmental utilization of AI to deliver services to Brazilian citizens.</i>	 Compute Capacity: Compute Capacity remains a significant bottleneck, pointing to limited high-performance computing infrastructure necessary for advanced AI development. <i>We note that Brazil is making strides to improve compute capacity but there still remains a significant gap between Brazil's computing needs and its current capacity.</i>
 Mature digital government infrastructure: Brazil performs exceptionally well in Government Digital Policy and E-Government Delivery. <i>We note that these scores are a function of the Brazilian Digital strategy which has resulted in the roll out of regulations covered above in the legislative overview. However, there are still bottlenecks in framework implementation.</i>	 Talent Gap: The report's assessment of Human Capital and AI Sector Maturity indicate gaps in deep technical talent and ecosystem development. <i>We note that Brazil is making strides to improve human resources but there still remains a significant gap between Brazil's needs and its current capacity.</i>
 Established regulatory frameworks: Brazil scores highly in Regulatory Compliance, Governance Principles and Safety and Security further suggest that Brazil has relatively robust legal and oversight mechanisms in place to support responsible AI deployment. <i>However, we note from separate research (covered in the above sections) that there are significant challenges to the effective deployment of these regulations.</i>	 Uneven Adoption: Low scores in AI Technology Diffusion and Societal Transition suggest uneven adoption across the broader economy and society. <i>We note that this is a function of geographical spread, inequities in access, and AI enablement of services that aren't utilized evenly nationally.</i>

OECD FRAMEWORK: A GOVERNANCE LENS

Strengths	Constraints
 Alignment with international governance principles: Brazil's national AI strategy (EBIA) + ongoing legislative efforts align with OECD's governance approaches. <i>We note that this alignment positions Brazil to integrate more seamlessly into global AI governance frameworks and strengthens its credibility as a regulatory actor.</i>	 Fragmented Governance across institutions and levels of government: AI governance responsibilities are distributed across multiple institutions and levels of government, resulting in inconsistent implementation across sectors. <i>We note that this fragmentation reflects deeper structural challenges in Brazil's federal system.</i>
 Active Cross-Sectoral Participation: MCTI, ANPD, among others, are actively engaged in shaping AI governance in Brazil. <i>We note that this broad institutional participation creates a strong foundation for inclusive governance, but requires formal coordination mechanisms to enable cohesive system-wide implementation.</i>	 Lack of coordination mechanisms: Despite strong policy alignment, there is no formal, centralized mechanism to standardize AI adoption across agencies. <i>We note that this absence of coordination creates a critical gap between strategy and execution</i>
	 Inconsistent data governance and interoperability standards: Public-sector data systems remain siloed across federal, state, and municipal levels, limiting interoperability. <i>We note that these data fragmentation challenges are a key structural bottleneck to AI deployment, as they undermine the potential for accurate data-driven public service delivery.</i>

UNESCO FRAMEWORK: A SOCIETAL LENS

Strengths	Constraints
 Formal commitment to ethical AI principles: EBIA explicitly identifies ethical, responsible, and human-centered AI as a guiding pillar, emphasizing transparency, accountability, and respect for fundamental rights.	 Limited enforcement of accountability and transparency mechanisms: While legal and policy frameworks emphasize transparency and accountability, enforcement remains low in practice.
 Emerging recognition of rights-based AI frameworks: A notable example is CNJ Resolution No. 615/2025, which establishes binding requirements for AI use within Brazil’s judiciary, including mandatory system registration, transparency obligations, external audits for high-risk systems, and prohibitions on discriminatory profiling.	 Absence of standardized audit and monitoring systems: Brazil has no formal national framework for AI auditing or monitoring, nor any standardized methodologies or designated institutions to evaluate bias, fairness, or system performance at scale.
	 Insufficient safeguards to mitigate bias and harm: Harm detection occurs post-deployment, as evidenced by failures in INSS automation and biased facial recognition systems.

AI readiness is multi-dimensional and requires evaluation from varied approaches. Capacity benchmarks (Oxford Index) assess whether systems can be managed effectively, governance frameworks (OECD) determine whether systems can be managed effectively, and societal frameworks (UNESCO) assess whether outcomes are equitable and legitimate. In Brazil, these dimensions are developing unevenly. Operationally Brazil is leading the region, which suggests that the primary constraint is not Brazil’s technological capability, rather, the absence of coordinated governance and impact safeguards required for responsible deployment and scale.

Appendix C: Key Actors Landscape

Brazil's AI ecosystem is supported by a diverse set of actors across government, civil society, research institutions, private sector firms, and global philanthropic networks. These actors contribute to policy development, implementation, oversight, and infrastructure, however, they often operate in a siloed manner with varying levels of coordination, capacity, and alignment.

Key Actors in Brazil's AI Ecosystem

ACTOR	CORE ROLE	STRENGTHS	CONSTRAINTS	STRATEGIC RELEVANCE
Government	- Policy Design - Regulation - Oversight of AI Systems	- Institutional Legitimacy - Regulatory Authority - National Reach	- Fragmentation across agencies - Limited Coordination - Political Exposure	BRAVA should engage selectively here. Prioritize coordination and Institutional capacity-building over direct Implementation.
Civil Society & Research Institutions	- Research - Oversight - Policy Transformation - Capacity-building	- Technical credibility - Political neutrality - Continuity across political cycles	- Limited funding - Constrained ability to scale technical Infrastructure	These are ideal primary partners for BRAVA. High alignment with institutional strengthening
Private Sector	- Infrastructure provision - AI development - Funding Influence	- Capital scale - Technical expertise - Infrastructure capability	- Conflicts of Interest - Weak accountability - Environmental and governmental risks	BRAVA should engage cautiously here. Technical expertise can be selectively leveraged, along with co-funding potentially.
Global Philanthropy	- Capital aggregation - Agenda-setting - Global coordination	- Large-scale funding - Governance frameworks - International networks	- Less localized context - Coordination complexity - Broad and non-specific focus	Selective participation for co-financing and knowledge exchange; maintain focus on Brazil-specific impact

Appendix D: Full Partner Scoring

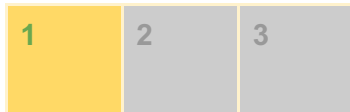
Name of Organization & Project	Institutional Strength	Technical Capability and Track Record	Financial Sustainability	Building Institutional and Social Capacity	Accountability and Democratic Oversight	Transparency	Equality and Inclusive Access	TOTAL AVERAGE SCORE
Intervention Modality 1: Institutional Capacity and Technical Assistance								
Nova Escola (Professor ANE - WhatsApp AI Lesson Planner)	3	3	3	3	3	3	2	2.9
Inspier (Agile AI & Expert Connections)	3	3	3	3	2	2	3	2.8
MegaEdu (Connectivity Planning & Technical Assistance)	2	2	1	2	1	1	2	1.7
Intervention Modality 2: Data Governance and Public Infrastructure								
Instituto Decodifica (Luminate Project)	1	2	1	1	3	3	3	1.8
Lemann Foundation (AI Alliance)	3	3	3	3	2	2	2	2.7
NIC.br (OBIA - Brazilian Artificial Intelligence Observatory)	3	3	3	1	2	3	2	2.1
FGV Direito Rio (AI Hub)	2	3	1	1	1	1	2	1.5
Intervention Modality 3: Civil Society and Oversight Strengthening								
InternetLab (Sectoral Impact of AI)	3	2	1	2	1	2	2	1.9
InternetLab (Data Justice and Social Protection)	3	2	2	1	1	1	2	1.6

<i>Policies)</i>								
InternetLab <i>(Education and Surveillance Technologies)</i>	3	2	1	2	2	2	2	2.0
Base dos Dados <i>(BD Lab)</i>	2	3	1	2	3	3	2	2.2

Instituto Decodifica - Luminate Project

Total Average Score: 1.8

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Includes broadly defined outcomes reflecting the project's focus on generating more inclusive and accurate data on policy impacts in peripheral communities of Rio de Janeiro⁹³, where demonstrable impact may be difficult to measure.

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



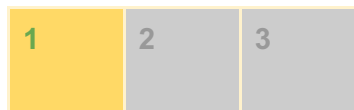
Demonstrates limited experiences with respect to AI-related projects⁹⁴, and their current work on the Luminate project represents their first AI advocacy-focused initiative⁹⁵. Given their limited experience in this field.

⁹³ Laryssa Nunes and Claudio Mendes, interview by SIPA team, *Instituto Decodifica*, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 16, 2026

⁹⁴ Decodifica. "Projetos." *Instituto Decodifica*. Accessed April 10, 2026. <https://decodifica.org/projetos/>

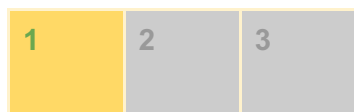
⁹⁵ Laryssa Nunes, email to SIPA Team, March 20, 2026

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability



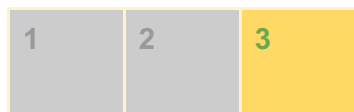
Reflects limited information on measurable outcomes, suggesting vague potential for scaling across other cities in Brazil, and an unclear link between investments to measurable impact. However, the project has received other funding, indicating co-funding opportunities⁹⁶.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity



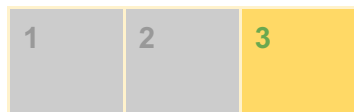
Works within the thematic area of building public value, aiming to promote institutional and regulatory change. The project collects accurate data about the impact of existing policies such as the AI powered facial recognition technology across Rio de Janeiro, on peripheral communities, and utilises this to advocate for regulatory change⁹⁷.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight



Indicates structured accountability and opportunities for redressal through their citizen data generation methodology⁹⁸, where findings are first presented to the affected community for validation before being taken forward for advocacy with relevant stakeholders⁹⁹. This reflects a highly participatory approach to advocacy.

Criteria 6: Transparency



⁹⁶ Laryssa Nunes and Claudio Mendes, interview by SIPA team, *Instituto Decodifica*, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 16, 2026

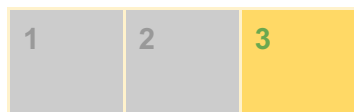
⁹⁷ Ibid

⁹⁸ Instituto Decodifica, "Apresentação," *Instituto Decodifica*, accessed April 10, 2026, <https://decodifica.org/apresentacao/>

⁹⁹ Laryssa Nunes and Claudio Mendes, interview by SIPA team, *Instituto Decodifica*, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 16, 2026

Maintains transparent measures through their citizen data generation methodology. This approach allows for opportunities such as workshops and presentations to allow the affected community to participate and provide insights throughout each stage of the project¹⁰⁰, indicating high standards upheld for transparency.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access



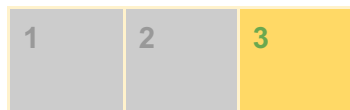
Demonstrates participatory governance, with a project design aimed at preventing AI from reinforcing existing structural inequalities and ensuring that diverse perspectives are represented through accurate data in relation to regulatory policy and AI adoption¹⁰¹.

¹⁰⁰ Ibid

¹⁰¹ Ibid

Total Average Score: 1.9

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



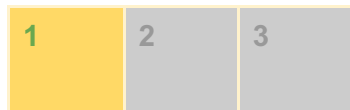
Demonstrates strong objectives and outcomes for the research project, with a clear methodology, and regular publications of findings. This indicates a structured research process and ongoing dissemination of results.¹⁰²

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Indicates a sustained track record of working to produce knowledge products and strengthen oversight into use of technology and its impact on human rights¹⁰³. The entity also has a strong track record of prior projects focused on analysing the impact of technology advancements, such as facial recognition on privacy and security¹⁰⁴.

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability:



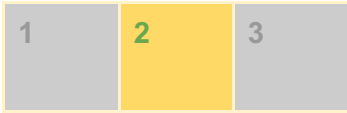
Indicates limited information in the public domain with respect to co-founding opportunities and investment to impact ratio.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity:

¹⁰² InternetLab, *Impactos setoriais da IA: agenda emergente em cultura, educação e direitos das crianças e adolescentes*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/impactos-setoriais-da-ia-agenda-emergente-em-cultura-educacao-e-direitos-das-criancas-e-adolescentes/>

¹⁰³ UNESCO, "InternetLab," *Global Civil Society Organizations and Academic Network on AI Ethics and Policy*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://www.unesco.org/ethics-ai/en/civil-society-organizations/internetlab>

¹⁰⁴ InternetLab, "EdTech – Surveillance and Education Technologies," *InternetLab*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/en/projetos/edtech-surveillance-and-education-technologies/>



Works within the thematic area of building public value and youth education & wellbeing by examining how generative AI systems affect culture, education and the rights and wellbeing of children and adolescents. The work supports youth education and wellbeing by assessing both enabling uses of AI in learning environments and associated risks related to autonomy, privacy and cognitive development¹⁰⁵.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight:



Provides limited information on accountability and democratic oversight mechanisms built as a part of the project.

Criteria 6: Transparency:



Ensures regular publishing of reports and findings¹⁰⁶ as a part of the project, maintaining transparency in terms of activities and outcomes. This consistent sharing of data supports transparency, and enables stakeholders to track progress and assess evidence generated.

¹⁰⁵ InternetLab, *Impactos setoriais da IA: agenda emergente em cultura, educação e direitos das crianças e adolescentes*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/impactos-setoriais-da-ia-agenda-emergente-em-cultura-educacao-e-direitos-das-criancas-e-adolescentes/>

¹⁰⁶ InternetLab, *Sectoral Impacts of Artificial Intelligence: An Emerging Agenda in Culture, Education, and the Rights of Children and Adolescents* (São Paulo: InternetLab, 2025), https://internetlab.org.br/wp-content/uploads/2025/11/Impactos-setoriais-da-IA_report-EN.pdf

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access:



Addresses a key area of concern through the objective of the project¹⁰⁷, to assess the impact of the use of AI on the education and wellbeing of children and adolescents, including implication for intellectual autonomy, privacy, risks to development of fundamental cognitive skills.

¹⁰⁷ InternetLab, Impactos setoriais da IA: agenda emergente em cultura, educação e direitos das crianças e adolescentes, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/impactos-setoriais-da-ia-agenda-emergente-em-cultura-educacao-e-direitos-das-criancas-e-adolescentes/>

InternetLab - Data Justice and Social Protection Policies

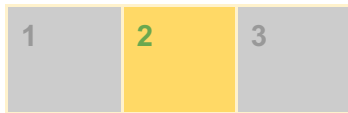
Total Average Score:1.6

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Demonstrates strong objectives and outcomes for the research project, with a clear methodology, and regular publications of findings. This indicates a structured research process and ongoing dissemination of results.¹⁰⁸

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Indicates a sustained track record of working to produce knowledge products and strengthen oversight into use of technology and its impact on human rights¹⁰⁹. The entity also has a strong track record of prior projects focused on analysing the impact of technology advancements, such as facial recognition on

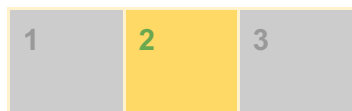
privacy and security¹¹⁰.

¹⁰⁸ InternetLab, *Impactos setoriais da IA: agenda emergente em cultura, educação e direitos das crianças e adolescentes*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/impactos-setoriais-da-ia-agenda-emergente-em-cultura-educacao-e-direitos-das-criancas-e-adolescentes/>

¹⁰⁹ UNESCO, "InternetLab," *Global Civil Society Organizations and Academic Network on AI Ethics and Policy*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://www.unesco.org/ethics-ai/en/civil-society-organizations/internetlab>

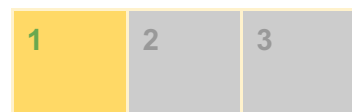
¹¹⁰ InternetLab, "EdTech – Surveillance and Education Technologies," *InternetLab*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/en/projetos/edtech-surveillance-and-education-technologies/>

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability:



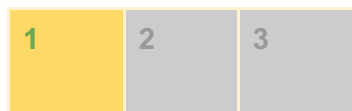
Demonstrates some opportunities for scaling up, since this program is continuation of previous research studies on data practices of social programs provided by CadÚnico¹¹¹. Additionally, support from entities such as Privacy International and University of St.Gallen indicates co-funding opportunities¹¹².

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity:



Maintains engagement with only one thematic area: building public value, by assessing the impact of the use of algorithms and automated decisions for social beneficiary programs¹¹³.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight:



Provides limited information on regular updates of research findings, making assessment of the program's current progress and frequency with which outputs are shared difficult¹¹⁴.

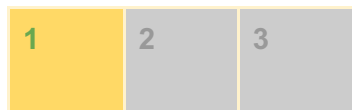
¹¹¹InternetLab. "Justiça de dados e políticas de proteção social no Brasil: algoritmos e decisões automatizadas no CadÚnico." Accessed April 16, 2026. <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/justica-de-dados-e-politicas-de-protecao-social-no-brasil-algoritmos-e-decisoes-automatizadas-no-cadunico/>

¹¹²Ibid

¹¹³Ibid

¹¹⁴ Ibid

Criteria 6: Transparency:



Indicates limited evidence of basic transparency measures, including clearly defined measurable outcomes and insight into the approach and methodology for assessing gaps in the use of algorithms and automated decision making for social benefit programs.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access:



Aims to address a structural concern through its program design by assessing the impact of advanced technologies used by the Unified Registry for Social Programs (CadÚnico) on social rights in Brazil¹¹⁵.

¹¹⁵ InternetLab. "Justiça de dados e políticas de proteção social no Brasil: algoritmos e decisões automatizadas no CadÚnico." Accessed April 16, 2026. <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/justica-de-dados-e-politicas-de-protecao-social-no-brasil-algoritmos-e-decisoes-automatizadas-no-cadunico/>

InternetLab - Education and Surveillance Technologies

Total Average Score:2.0

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



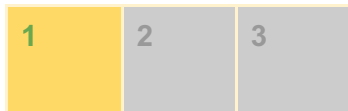
Demonstrates strong objectives and outcomes for the research project, with a clear methodology, and regular publications of findings. This indicates a structured research process and ongoing dissemination of results.¹¹⁶

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Indicates a sustained track record of working to produce knowledge products and strengthen oversight into use of technology and its impact on human rights¹¹⁷. The entity also has a strong track record of additional projects focused on analysing the impact of technology advancements, such as facial recognition on privacy and security¹¹⁸.

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability:



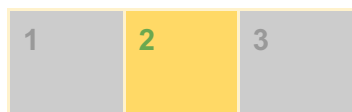
¹¹⁶ InternetLab, *Impactos setoriais da IA: agenda emergente em cultura, educação e direitos das crianças e adolescentes*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/pt/projetos/impactos-setoriais-da-ia-agenda-emergente-em-cultura-educacao-e-direitos-das-criancas-e-adolescentes/>

¹¹⁷ UNESCO, "InternetLab," *Global Civil Society Organizations and Academic Network on AI Ethics and Policy*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://www.unesco.org/ethics-ai/en/civil-society-organizations/internetlab>

¹¹⁸ InternetLab, "EdTech – Surveillance and Education Technologies," *InternetLab*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/en/projetos/edtech-surveillance-and-education-technologies/>

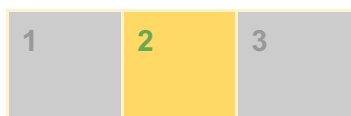
Provides limited information in the public domain on any opportunities for scaling-up and co-funding, with an unclear investment to impact ratio. The program's partnership with Privacy International demonstrates limited co-funding opportunities¹¹⁹.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity:



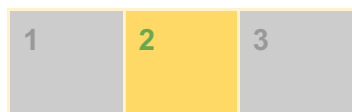
Maintains engagement with two core thematic areas: building public value and supporting youth education and wellbeing. The program's main objective of assessing the impact and risks involved with utilising facial recognition technology for educational institutions indicates its work ensuring youth wellbeing, and assessment of justifications of such policies, protocols for data collection and storage indicates building public value¹²⁰.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight:



Provides regular updates, with a report published in 2025¹²¹ and another in 2023¹²², demonstrating a consistent sharing of output and research findings. This acts as an indicator of institutional commitment to keep stakeholders informed of research updates and progress.

Criteria 6: Transparency:



¹¹⁹ Ibid

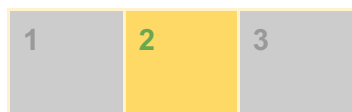
¹²⁰ Ibid

¹²¹ InternetLab. "Surveillance Technologies and Artificial Intelligence in Education: Promises of Modernization, Realities of Opacity." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/Report-I-Surveillance-Technologies-and-Artificial-Intelligence-in-Education-Promises-of-modernization-realities-of-opacity.pdf>

¹²² InternetLab. "Educação na mira." Accessed April 16, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/Educacao-na-mira-EN-03.pdf>

Includes transparency measures of its findings within each report, providing details on data collection methodology, allowing stakeholders to understand the scope and limitations of the research conducted and findings presented¹²³.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access:



Examines as a central question, whether existing structural biases are being reinforced by the use of technology, with a program design ensuring that a varied sample of 15 policies across states of Brazil are reviewed in this study¹²⁴. This ensures broad geographic coverage and representativeness of the findings of the study.

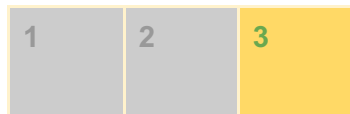
123 InternetLab. "Surveillance Technologies and Artificial Intelligence in Education: Promises of Modernization, Realities of Opacity." Accessed April 16, 2026, page 8-10 <https://internetlab.org.br/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/Report-I-Surveillance-Technologies-and-Artificial-Intelligence-in-Education-Promises-of-modernization-realities-of-opacity.pdf>

124 InternetLab, "EdTech – Surveillance and Education Technologies," *InternetLab*, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://internetlab.org.br/en/projetos/edtech-surveillance-and-education-technologies/>

NIC.br and Cetic.br - Brazilian Artificial Intelligence Observatory:

Total Average Score: 1.9

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Demonstrates strong and clear governance structures as a well-established nonprofit with over 20 years of operation, a unique self-sustaining funding model through .br domain registration fees, and UNESCO Category 2 Center status since 2012¹²⁵. Formal institutional partnerships with the Ministry of Education, IDB, and UNESCO further reflect organizational credibility and clearly defined operational frameworks¹²⁶.

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Demonstrates clear technical competence and a strong track record in AI measurement and knowledge production, running six regular ICT surveys across enterprises, governments, schools, and individuals, with AI indicators introduced as early as 2020¹²⁷. OBIA's four-dimensional indicator framework covering the government, health, education, and economic sectors, developed in collaboration with ITU, UNESCO, IRCAI, and the OECD, reflects strong technical credibility and alignment with global best practices.¹²⁸

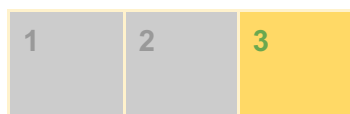
Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability

¹²⁵ Manuella Maia Ribeiro, interview by SIPA team, *NIC.br*, virtual interview, March 27, 2026

¹²⁶ Ibid.

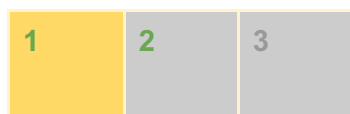
¹²⁷ Ibid.

¹²⁸ Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, "OBIA, the Brazilian AI Observatory," Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://indicelatom.cl/obia-the-brazilian-ai-observatory/>



Demonstrates strong and unique financial durability through its self-sustaining .br domain registration fee model, which generates consistent annual revenue independent of donor cycles or government appropriations¹²⁹. The 11 AI centers contributing to OBIA have collectively attracted 240 million reais in public and private investment through 2030, further reinforcing long-term financial stability¹³⁰.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity



Engages with institutional capacity-building through survey data that informs public policy and national AI plans, and through training governments to use CETIC.br indicators as benchmarks and monitoring tools¹³¹. However, engagement remains indirect: NIC.br produces knowledge that others act on rather than delivering frontline interventions.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight



Maintains some evidence of accountability through multisectoral expert groups convened for each survey, including government, civil society, and enterprise associations, that help define indicators and methodologies, and through the multisectoral governance committee being established for OBIA¹³².

However, it is worth noting that OBIA is co-led by Brazil's Ministry of Science, Technology, and Innovation¹³³, creating a degree of government entanglement that may limit independence in oversight functions, a structural concern relevant to BRAVA's preference for arms-length, non-coalition partnerships.

Criteria 6: Transparency

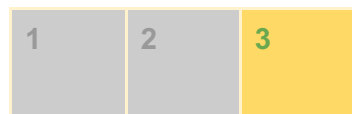
¹²⁹ Manuella Maia Ribeiro, interview by SIPA team, *NIC.br*, virtual interview, March 27, 2026

¹³⁰ Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, "OBIA, the Brazilian AI Observatory," Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://indicelatam.cl/obia-the-brazilian-ai-observatory/>

¹³¹ Manuella Maia Ribeiro, interview by SIPA team, *NIC.br*, virtual interview, March 27, 2026

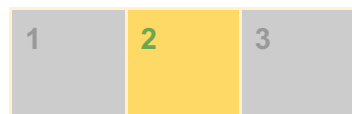
¹³² Ibid.

¹³³ Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, "OBIA, the Brazilian AI Observatory," Índice Latinoamericano de Inteligencia Artificial, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://indicelatam.cl/obia-the-brazilian-ai-observatory/>



Demonstrates strong transparency measures as a public, open-access knowledge institution by publishing ICT survey results openly, contributing indicators to OBIA as a freely accessible repository, and actively disseminating findings through webinars, conferences, and translated materials in partnership with UNESCO and Oxford University¹³⁴

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access



Demonstrates meaningful attention to equity through surveys that measure AI adoption gaps among vulnerable populations, including children aged 9 to 17 through the ICT Kids Online Survey and individuals in low-connectivity environments, generating data that inform equity-oriented public policy¹³⁵. However, NIC.br documents structural inequalities rather than directly addressing them.

¹³⁴ Ibid.

¹³⁵ Manuella Maia Ribeiro, interview by SIPA team, *NIC.br*, virtual interview, March 27, 2026

FGV Direito Rio - AI Hub:

Total Average Score: 1.4

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Maintains some nascent governance structure in the form of an AI research hub¹³⁶, with a Data and AI regulations research group. The work of this research group is to assess data protection and AI governance practices, providing advice for areas of improvement to private sector and AI regulatory actors.¹³⁷

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Demonstrates a strong track record of previous projects within the field of technology and its impact on public good. A key example is the project on regulation of online content on private digital platforms, focusing on content moderation, AI-driven decision making, which aimed to produce key research articles and a proposal for legislative reform¹³⁸.

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability:

¹³⁶ Fundação Getúlio Vargas Direito Rio, "AI Hub – Artificial Intelligence," accessed April 13, 2026, <https://direitorio.fgv.br/en/research/ai-hub-artificial-intelligence>

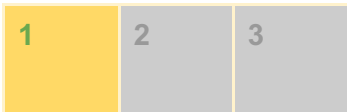
¹³⁷ Fundação Getúlio Vargas Direito Rio, "Data and AI Regulations," accessed April 13, 2026, <https://direitorio.fgv.br/en/research/data-and-ai-regulations>

¹³⁸ Fundação Getúlio Vargas Direito Rio, "Regulação de Conteúdo Online," accessed April 13, 2026, <https://direitorio.fgv.br/pesquisa/regulacao-de-conteudo-online>



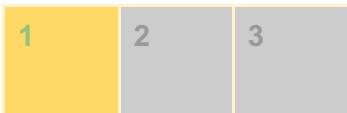
Indicates limited information on opportunities for scaling up and co-funding, with an unclear investment to impact ratio.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity:



Demonstrates focus on building public value primarily, through research and advisory work on AI and data governance in Brazil. The outputs from this research aim to support private actors in their adoption of AI, along with regulatory authorities such as the National Data Protection Agency (ANPD) in improving implementation of data protection and AI regulation¹³⁹.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight:



Provides limited information on AI advocacy accountability measures including defined objectives and expected results, such as research papers, proposed legislation, etc.¹⁴⁰

Criteria 6: Transparency:

¹³⁹ Fundação Getúlio Vargas Direito Rio, "Data and AI Regulations," accessed April 13, 2026, <https://diretorio.fgv.br/en/research/data-and-ai-regulations>

¹⁴⁰ Fundação Getúlio Vargas Direito Rio, "Data and AI Regulations," accessed April 13, 2026, <https://diretorio.fgv.br/en/research/data-and-ai-regulations>



Indicates limited evidence of basic transparency measures, including clearly defined measurable outcomes and insight into the approach and methodology for assessing gaps in AI adoption in Brazil.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access:



Maintains evidence of aiming to support equality and inclusive access to AI through the project's aim of improved implementation of personal data protection regulations and encouraging the developing of effective AI regulatory frameworks¹⁴¹

¹⁴¹ Ibid

Nova Escola - (Professor ANE - WhatsApp AI Lesson Planner)

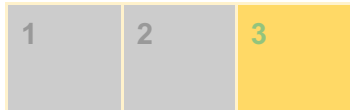
Total Average Score: 2.9

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Demonstrates strong and clear governance structures as a 40-year-old institution with a named executive director for 15 years, its website receiving 2 million monthly visitors and 800,000 subscribed users¹⁴², and an annual survey of 7,000 teachers across all 26 states in Brazil, reflecting strong national institutional reach and sustained organizational credibility¹⁴³.

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Demonstrates clear technical competence and a strong track record in AI-integrated education, including 120,000 teachers using the WhatsApp AI lesson planner in its first year¹⁴⁴, a multi-agent architecture with an LLM-as-a-judge safeguard system, and a localized government-connected version deployed in partnership with municipal and state Secretariats of Education¹⁴⁵.

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability

¹⁴² Patrick J. McGovern Foundation, "As AI Transforms Education, Nova Escola Is Empowering Teachers in Brazil to Lead the Way," Medium, February 14, 2025, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://medium.com/patrick-j-mcgovern-foundation/as-ai-transforms-education-nova-escola-is-empowering-teachers-in-brazil-to-lead-the-way-9fb36c5c90bf>

¹⁴³ Ibid.

¹⁴⁴ Ana Ligia Scachetti, interview by SIPA team, *Nova Escola*, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 20, 2026

¹⁴⁵ Ibid.



Benefits from strong opportunities for scaling and sustained impact through a diversified funding base, including formal partnerships with Meta, Microsoft, the Patrick J. McGovern Foundation, and the Tinker Foundation, alongside collaboration with the Lemann Foundation ecosystem, indicating broad co-funding interest from both private technology companies and philanthropic organizations¹⁴⁶.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity



Engages across all three thematic areas, building institutional capacity through teacher training and government Secretariat partnerships, building public value through a nationally accessible WhatsApp AI solution aligned with Brazil's national standards on digital culture, and supporting youth wellbeing through classroom AI integration and dedicated lesson plans, online courses, and campaigns.¹⁴⁷

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight

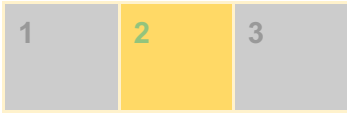


Demonstrates multiple accountability measures, including an LLM-as-a-judge system to evaluate all AI-generated content, continuous monitoring of teacher engagement, and the decision to abandon an anti-racist chatbot when results were insufficiently reliable, reflecting a principled and structured approach to responsible AI deployment.

Criteria 6: Transparency

¹⁴⁶ Ana Ligia Scachetti, interview by SIPA team, *Nova Escola*, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 20, 2026

¹⁴⁷ Patrick J. McGovern Foundation, "As AI Transforms Education, Nova Escola Is Empowering Teachers in Brazil to Lead the Way," Medium, February 14, 2025, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://medium.com/patrick-j-mcgovern-foundation/as-ai-transforms-education-nova-escola-is-empowering-teachers-in-brazil-to-lead-the-way-9fb36c5c90bf>



Maintains some transparency measures through explicit in-tool disclosure of AI use to teachers in compliance with national law, and annual publication of teacher survey data on AI adoption and attitudes across all 26 states, though the solutions are built on proprietary platforms, including WhatsApp and ChatGPT¹⁴⁸, which limits full transparency over the underlying systems and decision logic.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access



Demonstrates meaningful attention to equity through a free, WhatsApp-based AI tool designed for mobile devices in low-connectivity environments, including rural and remote regions¹⁴⁹, directly addressing the structural disparity between free and paid AI tools that affects the vast majority of Brazil's public school population.

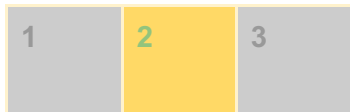
¹⁴⁸ Ana Ligia Scachetti, interview by SIPA team, *Nova Escola*, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 20, 2026

¹⁴⁹ Patrick J. McGovern Foundation, "As AI Transforms Education, Nova Escola Is Empowering Teachers in Brazil to Lead the Way," Medium, February 14, 2025, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://medium.com/patrick-j-mcgovern-foundation/as-ai-transforms-education-nova-escola-is-empowering-teachers-in-brazil-to-lead-the-way-9fb36c5c90bf>.

MegaEdu - Connectivity Planning & Technical Assistance:

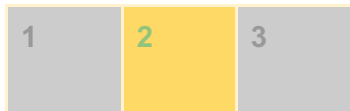
Total Average Score: 1.9

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Demonstrates emerging institutional credibility as a nonprofit founded in 2022, with partnerships across 10 states and more than 150 municipalities spanning every region of Brazil, and a documented impact of 10 million students reached through school connectivity initiatives¹⁵⁰. However, as a relatively young organization with three years of operation, long-term organizational stability remain nascent.

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:

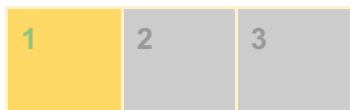


Demonstrates meaningful technical competence and a strong track record in digital infrastructure delivery, having scaled school connectivity from 9,000 to 90,000 public schools and developed a WhatsApp-based connectivity planning tool recognized as the best product for closing Brazil's digital divide in 2023¹⁵¹. However, MegaEdu's technical capability is in infrastructure, not AI specifically.

¹⁵⁰ Thomaz Galvão, interview by SIPA Team, *MegaEdu*, virtual interview, April 13, 2026

¹⁵¹ Ibid.

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability



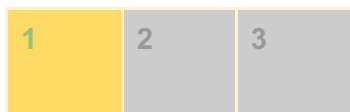
Limited information on financial sustainability. MegaEdu operates primarily through free technical consultancy to government partners, with insufficient evidence of a diversified or durable funding base to support scaling.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity



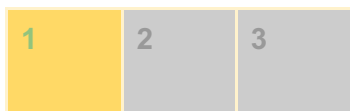
Engages directly with institutional capacity building through free technical assistance to states and municipalities, supporting the development of connectivity plans, management systems, and data capabilities across 27 states¹⁵². While this work is foundational to responsible AI use in public schools, MegaEdu's focus remains on infrastructure prerequisites.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight



Indicates limited evidence of structured accountability or oversight mechanisms within MegaEdu's operations. The organization's equity focus is genuine, but accountability infrastructure is not documented.

Criteria 6: Transparency

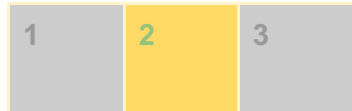


Reflects limited transparency measures, with no documented public disclosure of operations, activity reports, or data governance practices discussed in the interview. MegaEdu acknowledges using AI tools

¹⁵² Ibid.

internally (including Gemini, ChatGPT, and Claude), but no formal transparency mechanisms around their use or around program outcomes are referenced¹⁵³.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access



Demonstrates strong and consistent attention to equity as the core institutional mission, explicitly framing infrastructure connectivity as the prerequisite for equitable AI access in Brazil's public schools, and prioritizing the hardest-to-reach schools in the rural North and Northeast¹⁵⁴. No specific AI equity programming or bias mitigation measures are documented given MegaEdu's pre-AI infrastructure focus.

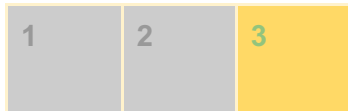
¹⁵³ Ibid.

¹⁵⁴ Ibid.

INSPER - Agile AI & Expert Connections

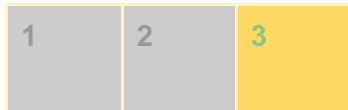
Total Average Score: 2.7

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Demonstrates strong organizational credibility through 130 international agreements¹⁵⁵, an OpenAI Partnership¹⁵⁶, and a 10-year partnership with Tata Consultancy Services that includes a jointly launched AI Research and Innovation Center¹⁵⁷, indicating clearly structured and milestone-driven institutional commitments.

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Demonstrates strong technical competence through operational AI initiatives, including a Ministry of Health data lake prototype, AI-integrated faculty dashboards, and Agile AI sprints delivering products to clients¹⁵⁸

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability

¹⁵⁵ Insper, "Global Partnerships," Insper, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://www.insper.edu.br/en/quem-somos/internacional/parcerias>

¹⁵⁶ Insper, "OpenAI Sees Agreement with Insper as a Model for Expanding ChatGPT Edu in Latin America," accessed April 13, 2026, <https://www.insper.edu.br/en/conteudos/tecnologia/openai-ve-acordo-com-insper-como-modelo-para-expansao-do-chatgpt-edu-na-america-latina>

¹⁵⁷ Tata Consultancy Services, "TCS Partners with Insper in Brazil, Invests \$50 Million to Accelerate Innovation in South America," *Tata Consultancy Services*, accessed April 12, 2026 <https://www.tcs.com/who-we-are/newsroom/press-release/tcs-partners-insper-brazil-invests-50mn-accelerate-innovation-south-america>

¹⁵⁸ Fabio Roberto de Miranda, interview by SIPA team, *Insper*, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 18, 2026



Benefits from co-funding potential through a partnership with the Becker Friedman Institute for Economics at the University of Chicago¹⁵⁹, as well as a significant investment from Tata Consultancy Services to jointly establish an AI-powered Research and Innovation Center, indicating strong opportunities for sustained financial backing and scaling.

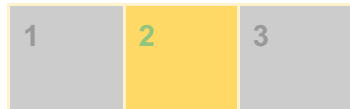
¹⁵⁹ Insper, "Research Investigates the Impact of AI on Consumption and Digital Inclusion," Insper, accessed April 12, 2026 <https://www.insper.edu.br/en/conteudos/marketing-e-vendas>

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity



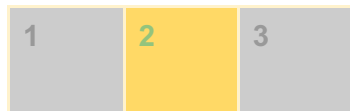
Engages across all three thematic areas through its AI-integrated curriculum, an expert connections program with civil society and industry partners, and its aspirations to open its platforms to broader public access¹⁶⁰.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight



Maintains some evidence of accountability through its formative assessment model¹⁶¹, which deliberately decouples AI-assisted work from graded outcomes, reflecting nascent but structured thinking around responsible AI use in education.

Criteria 6: Transparency



Demonstrates limited transparency practices: the Ministry of Health data lake represents an emerging commitment to public data accessibility, and publicly announced partnerships indicate institutional disclosure.

¹⁶⁰ Fabio Roberto de Miranda, interview by SIPA team, *Inspira*, in-person interview, São Paulo, March 18, 2026

¹⁶¹ Ibeto d

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access



Demonstrates strong commitment to equitable AI through student-led and faculty-led initiatives supported by Insper, including a free AI tutoring tool designed for public school students with limited connectivity and accessibility features for visually impaired users¹⁶², a study examining barriers to AI adoption among vulnerable communities, and a planned pilot to train workers in practical AI use¹⁶³.

¹⁶² Insper, "Company Created by Insper Students Develops Finalist Solution in Artificial Intelligence Competition," Insper, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://www.insper.edu.br/en/conteudos/tecnologia>

¹⁶³ Insper, "Research Investigates the Impact of AI on Consumption and Digital Inclusion," Insper, February 6, 2025, accessed April 13, 2026, <https://www.insper.edu.br/en/conteudos/marketing-e-vendas>

Lemann Foundation - AI Alliance:

Total Average Score: 2.7

Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:

 Demonstrates strong and clear governance structures as one of Brazil's most established education-focused philanthropic foundations, operating across a concentrated portfolio of core partner organizations with board-level engagement, a ten-year strategic plan through 2031, and formal institutional alliances across civil society, government, and the private sector ¹⁶⁴. The foundation's long-standing partnership history, including with Brava, MegaEdu, Nova Escola, and Base dos Dados, reflects clearly defined operational frameworks and sustained organizational credibility¹⁶⁵.

Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:

 Demonstrates strong technical competence and a growing track record in AI-integrated education, including the active piloting of Khanmigo in Brazilian public schools, grants to ed-tech organizations through the AI Alliance, and a pipeline of nearly 80 assessed solutions¹⁶⁶. Lemann has also invested in public dataset construction for literacy and mathematics assessment, developed an internal Portuguese-language AI product in

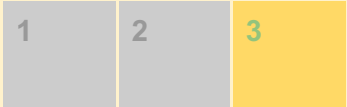
¹⁶⁴ Guilherme Cintra, interview by SIPA team, *Lemann Foundation*, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 17, 2026

¹⁶⁵ Tiago Maluta, interview by SIPA team, *Lemann Foundation*, virtual, April 6, 2026

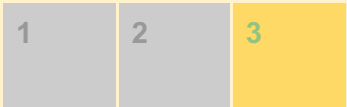
¹⁶⁶ Ibid.

partnership with Base dos Dados, and participated in international study trips to view digital public infrastructure in India alongside OBIA leadership.¹⁶⁷

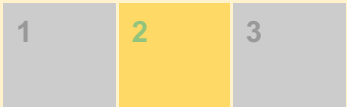
Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability

 Demonstrates strong financial sustainability through a diversified philanthropic model anchored by the AI Alliance, alongside a ten-year strategic planning horizon that reflects institutional commitment beyond individual grant cycles¹⁶⁸. The foundation's ability to redirect cost savings from AI-driven literacy assessments — approximately 7 million reais in the first year — toward teacher training further demonstrates financial adaptability¹⁶⁹.

Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity

 Engages strongly across all three thematic areas, building institutional capacity through the AI Alliance, the digital public infrastructure (DPI) framework, and management systems work with government at federal, state, and municipal levels; building public value through the dataset strategy and open infrastructure investments; and supporting youth wellbeing through AI pilots in mathematics and literacy for public school students¹⁷⁰. The foundation's explicit focus on designing for scale from the outset, rather than piloting without sustainability frameworks, further reflects a mature approach to institutional and social capacity building¹⁷¹.

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight

 Maintains some evidence of accountability through the AI Alliance's grant-making process, including a structured pipeline assessment of nearly 80 solutions and active monitoring of pilot outcomes, and through

¹⁶⁷ Ibid.

¹⁶⁸ Ibid.

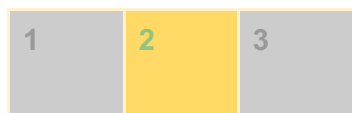
¹⁶⁹ Guilherme Cintra, interview by SIPA team, Lemann Foundation, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 17, 2026

¹⁷⁰ Ibid.

¹⁷¹ Ibid.

Lemann's practice of sitting on the boards of core portfolio organizations to ensure strategic alignment¹⁷². However, formal mechanisms for stakeholder redressal, public disclosure of AI use, or participatory program design with affected communities are not fully documented.

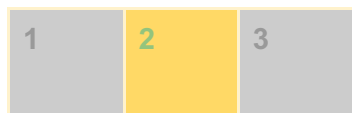
Criteria 6: Transparency



Reflects emerging transparency practices through the public-facing AI Alliance thesis and website, which documents the foundation's investment thesis around tutoring, mathematics assessment, and teacher support systems¹⁷³. Lemann's development of an internal AI product to query its own data in Portuguese

reflects a commitment to accessible knowledge management, though formal public disclosure mechanisms around AI utilization or program outcomes remain unclear.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access



Demonstrates meaningful attention to equity through an explicit focus on mathematics and literacy outcomes for public school students, populations that are disproportionately underserved, and through the AI Alliance's emphasis on contextualized implementation suited to Brazil's diverse and unequal

educational landscape¹⁷⁴. Lemann has positioned itself to support organizations with deep historical credibility in that space rather than lead directly, a structurally honest and equity-conscious stance¹⁷⁵

Base dos Dados - BD Lab:

¹⁷² Ibid.

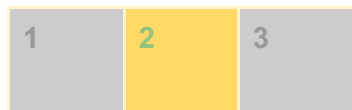
¹⁷³ Tiago Maluta, interview by SIPA team, *Lemann Foundation*, virtual, April 6, 2026

¹⁷⁴ Ibid

¹⁷⁵ Guilherme Cintra, interview by SIPA team, *Lemann Foundation*, in-person interview, Rio de Janeiro, March 17, 2026

Total Average Score: 2.2

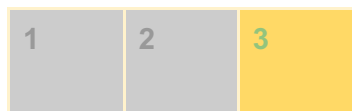
Criteria 1: Institutional Strength:



Demonstrates emerging but maturing institutional credibility as a nonprofit formally established in 2021, with a clear three-vertical organizational structure, OKR-based governance, an external audit approved for 2024, and a Fiscal Council with credentialed members from Harvard, Insper, and Unicamp¹⁷⁶.

However, the organization remains small, approximately 15-20 staff, and recorded an operating deficit of 11.29% in 2024.¹⁷⁷

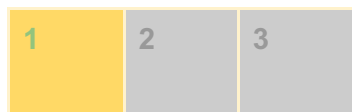
Criteria 2: Technical Capability and Track Record:



Demonstrates strong and well-documented technical competence, including 2.4 million datalake queries, 230 new processed data tables, and active public sector partnerships with the São Paulo city government, a municipal development institute, and the Lemann Foundation¹⁷⁸. The organization has received the

Google Cloud Customer Award in the Social Impact category, the only Brazilian organization selected, and won first place in the National Treasury Award for data science and AI applied to public finance, reflecting strong external validation of technical impact¹⁷⁹.

Criteria 3: Financial Sustainability



Reflects significant financial sustainability concerns, with a net operating deficit of approximately 99,000 reais in 2024, expenses growing 21.9% year-on-year, and revenue from donations declining 22.18%¹⁸⁰.

¹⁷⁶ Base dos dados, "About Us", accessed April 13, 2026 <https://basedosdados.org/about-us>

¹⁷⁷ Base dos dados, *Relatório de Atividades 2024* (São Paulo: Basedosdados, 2024), accessed April 13, 2026, <https://storage.googleapis.com/basedosdados-website>

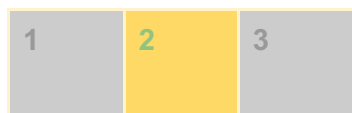
¹⁷⁸ Ibid.

¹⁷⁹ Base dos dados, "About Us", accessed April 13, 2026 <https://basedosdados.org/about-us>

¹⁸⁰ Base dos dados, *Relatório de Atividades 2024* (São Paulo: Basedosdados, 2024), accessed April 13, 2026, <https://storage.googleapis.com/basedosdados-website>

While consulting services through BD Lab generate around 70% of revenue and BD Pro subscriptions are growing, the organization explicitly describes itself as a "nonprofit startup" facing daily financial balance challenges, and there is no documented evidence of multi-year philanthropic commitments or a durable co-funding structure.¹⁸¹

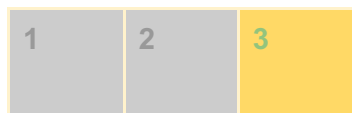
Criteria 4: Building Institutional and Social Capacity



Contributes to institutional capacity through public sector data engineering partnerships, including São Paulo's city government and a racial equity analysis project for Minas Gerais with Motriz, and to social capacity through BD Edu's data literacy training, open classes, and community workshops¹⁸². However,

BD Edu reached only 124 students in 2024, and the platform's primary user base continues to be technically literate users rather than broader civil society actors.¹⁸³

Criteria 5: Accountability and Democratic Oversight



Demonstrates multiple structured accountability and transparency tools serving democratic oversight, including Siga o Dinheiro, an interactive platform tracking R\$4.9 billion in electoral financing; a Câmara dos Deputados data campaign enabling citizen monitoring of legislative activity; and the publication of

electoral candidate and asset data dating back to 1994¹⁸⁴. The organization's explicit mission to strengthen democracy through open data access, recognized internationally by Google and the Brazilian National Treasury, reflects a deep institutional commitment to public accountability.

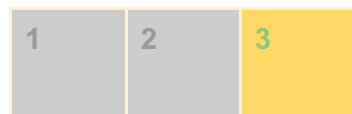
Criteria 6: Transparency

¹⁸¹ Ibid.

¹⁸² Ibid.

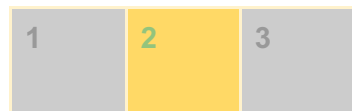
¹⁸³ Ibid.

¹⁸⁴ Ibid.



Demonstrates strong transparency practices through a fully open public datalake, an annual activity report with detailed financial statements, platform translation into English and Spanish, and an open source codebase maintained on GitHub with 33 active collaborators in 2024¹⁸⁵. The organization's mission explicitly frames transparency as foundational, and its community engagement model, including open classes, newsletters, and public campaigns, reflects consistent institutional openness.

Criteria 7: Equality and Inclusive Access



Demonstrates meaningful attention to equity through a racial equity data project supporting Minas Gerais public sector leadership diversity with Motriz, community workshops in peripheral neighborhoods including Capão Redondo in São Paulo, and scholarship campaigns for BD Edu courses targeting underserved learners¹⁸⁶. However, the organization acknowledges that its platform currently serves users who already have basic programming knowledge, limiting equitable access for non-technical users.

¹⁸⁵ Ibid.

¹⁸⁶ Ibid.